MAX1000-FORTH

Implementation Details — the HF16 CPU, its memory and peripherals in the MAX 10, the Forth kernel and the tools

MAX1000-FORTH 1.1

Generated 2026-11-06 from docs/design.md

This document describes how MAX1000-FORTH is built: the HF16 CPU in the FPGA of a Trenz MAX1000, its memory, the I/O registers and peripherals around it, the Forth kernel that runs on it and answers the app, and the tools that build and check all of it. It is written for someone who wants to understand, change or extend the design. How to *use* the Forth is in the user manual; the serial protocol the app speaks is protocol 1 of ZYNQ-FORTH (its `docs/Protocol.md`).

All figures in this document are those of release 1.1 (firmware 1.1, protocol 1, kernel of 323 words and 10,244 bytes), unless a section names release 1.0 for comparison. The PDF version, `docs/Implementation-Details.pdf`, is generated from this file by `python tools/manual_pdf.py design`.

Contents

1 Overview

- 1.1 Design goals
- 1.2 Who does what
- 1.3 The life of a line
- 1.4 Repository map

2 Platform and resources

- 2.1 The MAX1000 and the 10M08SAU169C8G
- 2.2 Resources used
- 2.3 Timing

3 The HF16 CPU

- 3.1 Machine model
- 3.2 Instruction formats
- 3.3 ALU functions
- 3.4 Primitives
- 3.5 Memory ports and timing
- 3.6 Next-state logic
- 3.7 The stacks in M9K

4 Memory and I/O

- 4.1 RAM
- 4.2 The I/O read path
- 4.3 I/O map
- 4.4 UART and FIFOs
- 4.5 Ctrl-R and restart
- 4.6 LEDs, button and millisecond timer
- 4.7 Pins and pin ownership
- 4.8 PWM
- 4.9 DDS
- 4.10 ADC and temperature diode
- 4.11 SPI master, serial flash, accelerometer and CRC-32

5 The Forth kernel

- 5.1 Two compilers that produce the same code
- 5.2 Memory layout
- 5.3 Dictionary headers
- 5.4 The layers

5.5 Primitives, inlining and execute
5.6 The interpreter
5.7 The compiler
5.8 What lands in RAM
5.9 Integer arithmetic
5.10 The DDS tuning word
5.11 Board words
5.12 Saved source and autostart
5.13 Service requests
5.14 What is left out

6 Tools and verification

6.1 tools/hf16.py
6.2 tools/mforth.py
6.3 sim/run_flash_tests.ps1
6.4 sim/test_protocol.py
6.5 Checks on the board
6.6 Found on the way

7 Building, flashing and releasing

7.1 The build chain
7.2 scripts/build.tcl
7.3 The kernel in the configuration
7.4 Getting it onto the board
7.5 Releases

8 The Windows app

9 Design decisions and room for growth

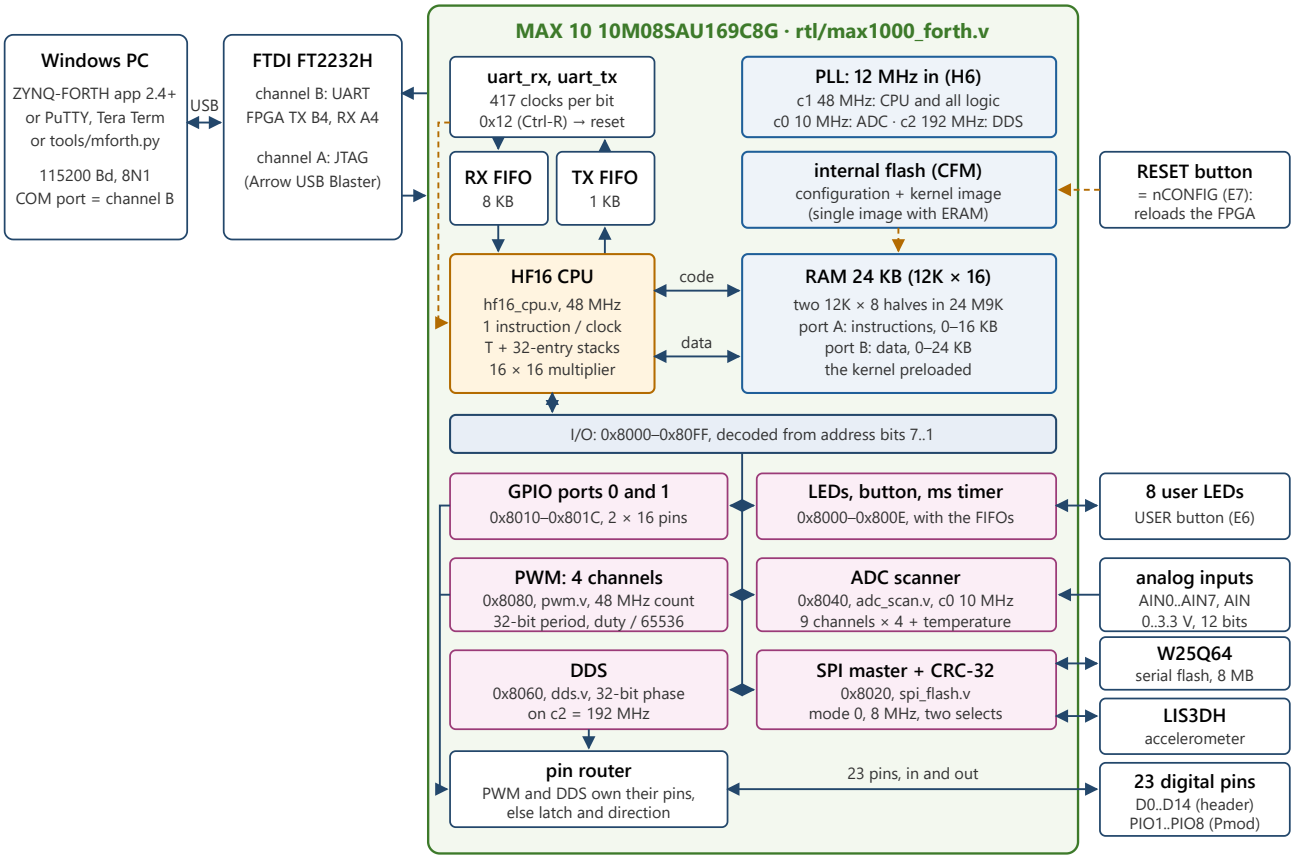
9.1 Decisions
9.2 Room for growth
9.3 What would not fit

1 Overview

MAX1000-FORTH turns a Trenz MAX1000 (TEI0001-02), a small board with an Intel MAX 10 FPGA, into an interactive Forth computer. The Forth runs on **HF16**, a 16-bit stack processor built in the FPGA's logic, whose instructions are Forth primitives. Everything that makes Forth Forth runs on HF16: reading the input line, looking words up, compiling new definitions, executing them, printing numbers.

The CPU, its instruction set and the core of the kernel come from the sister project ZYNQ-FORTH, where HF16 sits in the programmable logic of a Zynq and an ARM core loads its kernel, carries its terminal and answers the app. The MAX1000 has no such second processor, and MAX1000-FORTH does not add a soft one. Instead:

- the kernel image is the **initial content of the RAM**, part of the FPGA configuration, so Forth is ready the moment the MAX 10 has configured itself;
- the CPU talks to the PC **directly** through a UART on the board's FTDI chip, with FIFOs in block RAM between them;
- the **kernel itself** answers the app's service requests, between two terminal bytes;
- **Ctrl-R** (byte 0x12) resets the CPU in hardware, so a runaway program can always be stopped.



1.1 Design goals

- **A real Forth CPU.** Compiled Forth is native HF16 machine code: a colon definition is a sequence of 16-bit instructions, primitives are inlined as single instructions, a call takes one clock and a return is usually free. There is no inner interpreter.

- **Alone on a small FPGA.** No soft processor, no boot loader, no external memory: HF16, 24 KB of block RAM and the peripherals in a 10M08, the smallest common MAX 10, with half of its logic left free.
- **Always recoverable.** The kernel is never changed by what is typed (`cold` restores the dictionary), Ctrl-R works in any loop, and a saved source that misbehaves can be skipped at the start with ESC or the user button.
- **Compatible with ZYNQ-FORTH.** The same CPU (the Verilog file is identical), the same word names and stack effects for the common words, the same saved-source format and the same service protocol, so the ZYNQ-FORTH app (2.4 and later) works with the MAX1000.
- **Use the whole board.** 8 LEDs, the user button, 23 digital pins with four PWM channels and a DDS square-wave generator on any pin, nine analog inputs and the chip's temperature diode, the LIS3DH accelerometer and the 8 MB serial flash.
- **Small and checkable.** About 1,160 lines of Verilog (171 of them the CPU, plus Intel's ADC control core), a 766-line kernel, and an instruction-set simulator that runs the kernel exactly as the CPU does, against which 64 automatic checks run in seconds.

1.2 Who does what

There are three players: the FPGA logic, the Forth kernel running on HF16, and the PC tools that exist only at build time (and the app, which only talks the protocol).

	FPGA logic (`rtl/*.v`)	Forth kernel on HF16 (`forth/kernel.fs`)	PC tools (`tools/`, `scripts/`)
Start-up	Configures from the internal flash with the RAM image; holds the CPU in reset until the PLL locks and 255 clocks more	`cold`: restores the dictionary, counts the start, switches the accelerometer on, prints the banner, runs the saved source, enters `quit`	`hf16.py` cross-compiles the kernel into the RAM image; Quartus puts it into the `.pof`
Terminal	UART at 115,200 Bd, an 8 KB receive and a 1 KB send FIFO	`key`, `emit`, `accept-line`: reads, echoes, prints	—
Interpreting and compiling	—	All of it: parsing, dictionary search, numbers, compiling, executing	—
Arithmetic	One-clock ALU with a 16 × 16 multiplier (low and high product)	Division, 32-bit products and quotients, `*/`, the DDS tuning word	—
Board I/O	I/O registers: LEDs, button, timer, pins, PWM, DDS, ADC, SPI, CRC	Board words: `led!`, `pin@`, `pwm-hz`, `adc@`, `accel@`, `f-read` …	—
Service requests	Nothing special: the requests arrive in the same RX FIFO	`service?` answers them whenever Forth waits or polls	—
Saved source	SPI master and CRC-32 unit	`store` writes it to the W25Q64 flash, `autoload` runs it at every start	`mforth.py --store` sends it
Restart	Ctrl-R or a store to `$8008` resets the CPU, FIFOs and peripherals; the RAM keeps its contents	`cold` makes Forth fresh again	`mforth.py --restart`, `--skip`

Everything typed after the start is compiled by the kernel itself, on the FPGA.

1.3 The life of a line

What happens when `2 3 + .` and Enter are typed in a terminal or the app:

1. The PC writes the bytes to the board's second USB serial port. The FTDI FT2232H passes them out of channel B at 115,200 Bd, 8N1, to FPGA pin A4.
2. `uart_rx` samples the line with the 48 MHz CPU clock (417 clocks per bit), assembles each byte and pulses `valid` for one clock. The byte is not 0x12, so it is pushed into the 8 KB RX FIFO; it becomes visible to the CPU two clocks later.
3. HF16 is waiting in `key`, which loops on `key?`. `key?` calls `service?` (nothing to serve: the byte at the head of the FIFO is not SOH), sees bit 0 of the status register `$8002` set, peeks at the head byte through `$800C`, finds it is not SOH and returns true.
4. `key` reads `$8000`. The CPU has already put the address on the I/O bus in the previous instruction, so the byte is there at once; the instruction that consumes it (`@`, ALU op 13 with T = `$8000`) also pops the FIFO.
5. `accept-line` stores the character in `tib` and echoes it with `emit`, which waits for room in the TX FIFO (bit 1 of `$8002`) and stores the byte to `$8000`. The FIFO hands it to `uart_tx`, and the echo reaches the terminal about 87 µs per byte later.
6. At the CR, `accept-line` prints a space and returns. `interpret` takes `2`: not in the dictionary, a number, pushed. `3` likewise. `+` is found; it is an inline word, and in interpret state its code (one instruction and a return) is executed. `.` prints `5`. Then `quit` prints `ok` and CR LF, copies the data stack into `ssnap` for the app (`snap`), and waits for the next line.

And an app request, say `SOH stack LF` sent while Forth waits at the prompt:

1. The four bytes land in the RX FIFO like any others.
2. `key?` calls `service?`. It sees a SOH at the head of the FIFO (peek `$800C`), and neither the flash nor the accelerometer is selected (`$8022` bits 0 and 2), so it calls `serve`.
3. `serve` pops the SOH, sets `serving`, reads the request line up to LF (each byte within 2 s) into `rq`, takes the first word as the request name and `dispatch`es on it.
4. `answer` runs the payload word `p-stack` twice: once with `counting` set, where `emit` only counts bytes, then for real after the header `SOH ok stack <length> LF`. The payload is the snapshot `snap` took at the last prompt, e.g. `4 0009 0001 0002 FFFD`.
5. `serving` is cleared, `key?` looks at the FIFO again and goes on waiting for terminal input. The answer has appeared between two pieces of Forth's output, never inside one.

1.4 Repository map

Path	Content
`rtl/hf16_cpu.v`	the HF16 CPU, 171 lines, identical to ZYNQ-FORTH's
`rtl/max1000_forth.v`	top level: PLL, reset, RAM, UART and FIFOs, I/O decode and read multiplexer, LEDs, button, timer, pins, pin router
`rtl/fifo_bram.v`, `rtl/uart.v`	first-word-fall-through FIFOs in M9K, UART transmitter and receiver
`rtl/pwm.v`	four PWM channels (ZYNQ-FORTH's, with a separate read address)
`rtl/dds.v`	DDS square-wave generator on its own 192 MHz clock (after ZYNQ-FPGA-FORTH32's)
`rtl/adc_scan.v`	ADC scanner around Intel's Modular ADC control core

Path	Content
`rtl/spi_flash.v`	SPI master for the serial flash and the accelerometer, CRC-32 unit
`constr/max1000_forth.sdc`	timing constraints
`scripts/build.tcl`, `build.ps1`	Quartus project, pin assignments, build
`scripts/program_flash.ps1`	writes the `.pof` (or `.sof`) over JTAG
`scripts/Build-Release.ps1`	tests, build, manual PDF, release zip
`forth/kernel.fs`	the Forth kernel, 766 lines of Forth
`tools/hf16.py`	cross-compiler and instruction-set simulator (ISS)
`tools/mforth.py`	line sender, source store, restart from the PC
`tools/manual_pdf.py`	builds `docs/Manual.pdf` and `docs/Implementation-Details.pdf`
`sim/run_flash_tests.ps1`, `sim/test_protocol.py`	simulator tests: saved source (23 checks), service protocol (41 checks)
`examples/bench.fs`	the bench demo of the manual
`docs/`	user manual, this document, images

The app is not in this repository: it is the ZYNQ-FORTH app, which recognises the MAX1000 (chapter 8).

2 Platform and resources

2.1 The MAX1000 and the 10M08SAU169C8G

The **10M08SAU169C8G** is a MAX 10 FPGA: 8,064 logic elements (a 4-input LUT and a flip-flop each), 42 M9K block RAMs of 9 Kbit (387,072 bits), 24 embedded 18 × 18 multipliers (48 9-bit elements), one PLL with five outputs, one 12-bit 1 MSPS ADC with a temperature sensing diode, and its own configuration flash. "SA" is the single-supply version with the analog block, "U169" the 169-ball UBGA package, "C8" the commercial temperature range and speed grade 8. The MAX 10 configures itself from the internal flash at power-up, without an external configuration device.

The **TEI0001-02** board adds:

Part	Connection	Used for
12 MHz oscillator	FPGA pin H6	the PLL's input
FTDI FT2232H	channel A: JTAG (Arrow USB Blaster); channel B: UART, FPGA TX = B4, RX = A4	programming; the terminal
8 user LEDs	A8 A9 A11 A10 B10 C9 C10 D8 (LED1..LED8), active high	`led!`
USER button	E6, low while pressed (Schmitt-trigger input)	`btn@`, skipping the saved source
RESET button	nCONFIG (E7)	reloads the configuration; not an input for the design
Winbond W25Q64	F_S B3, F_CLK A3, F_DI A2, F_DO B2	8 MB serial flash: the saved source and free data
ST LIS3DH	SEN_CS L5, SEN_SPC J6, SEN_SDI J7, SEN_SDO K5	3-axis accelerometer
header	D0..D14, AIN0..AIN7, AIN	digital pins and analog inputs
Pmod	PIO_01..PIO_08	eight more digital pins

The board's flash is **not** used for configuration (the MAX 10 has its own), so all 8 MB are free for the Forth.

The PLL makes three clocks from the 12 MHz oscillator; its VCO runs at 960 MHz:

Output	Ratio	Frequency	Used by
c1	× 4	48 MHz	the CPU, RAM, FIFOs, UART, I/O registers, PWM, SPI, the ADC core's logic: one clock domain
c0	× 5 / 6	10 MHz	the ADC hard block's input clock
c2	× 16	192 MHz	the DDS phase accumulator

The SDC file declares the three outputs and the oscillator as asynchronous groups. Only the DDS settings cross from c1 to c2, through a toggle handshake (section 4.9); c0 only feeds the ADC block, whose control core runs on c1.

Why 48 MHz. HF16 executes one instruction per clock and addresses its data port with the *next* top of stack (section 3.5), so the path from the stack RAM through the ALU into the RAM's address register must fit in one clock. During the development of release 1.0 the design first ran at 40 MHz, because 48 MHz missed timing by 0.66 ns at the slow corner: the worst path ran from the data stack's M9K (2.6 ns clock-to-output) through the read-during-write bypass, the 16 × 16 multiplier (4.0 ns), the ALU multiplexer and the next-T logic, and then on through the I/O decode and read multiplexer into a registered `io_rdata`. The fix was to register the *address* instead (`io_addr`) and select the I/O value combinationally in the next cycle, as the M9K does with its own address register. The next-T path now ends at a register again, and 48 MHz passes with 1.5 ns to spare. 48 MHz also divides well: 48,000 clocks per millisecond, and 417 clocks per UART bit (115,108 Bd, 0.08 % slow).

2.2 Resources used

From the fitter report of the 1.1 release build (`build/output_files/max1000_forth.fit.rpt`, Quartus Prime Lite 18.1):

Resource	Used	Available	%
Logic elements	4,259	8,064	53
of which combinational functions	3,594	8,064	45
Registers	2,069	8,064	26
M9K blocks	36	42	86
Block memory bits	272,128	387,072	70
Embedded multiplier 9-bit elements	18	48	38
PLLs	1 (3 of 5 outputs)	1	100
ADC blocks	1	1	100
UFM blocks	0	1	0
Pins	43	130	33
Global clocks	3	10	30

By design unit:

Unit	Logic elements	Registers	M9K	Multiplier elements
`pwm` (4 channels)	1,734	1,220	–	16
`hf16_cpu`	869	93	2 (the stacks)	2
top level (`max1000_forth.v` itself)	716	172	–	–
`adc_scan` (of which Intel's control core 232)	431	247	1 (averaging FIFO)	–
`dds`	148	137	–	–
`spi_flash`	102	50	–	–
RX FIFO / TX FIFO	95 / 65	42 / 33	8 / 1	–
`uart_rx` / `uart_tx`	90 / 65	42 / 31	–	–
RAM (two halves, decode)	12	2	24	–

The 36 M9K blocks are the RAM (2 × 12), the RX FIFO (8), the TX FIFO (1), the two stacks (1 each) and the temperature averaging FIFO of the ADC core (1, 64 × 12 bits). The four PWM channels are by far the largest unit: four 32-bit counters, comparators and two pipeline stages of 32 × 16 products each. The CPU itself is 869 logic elements.

2.3 Timing

From the timing analyzer of the 1.1 build (`max1000_forth.sta.summary`), slow model, 1200 mV, 85 °C (the worst corner):

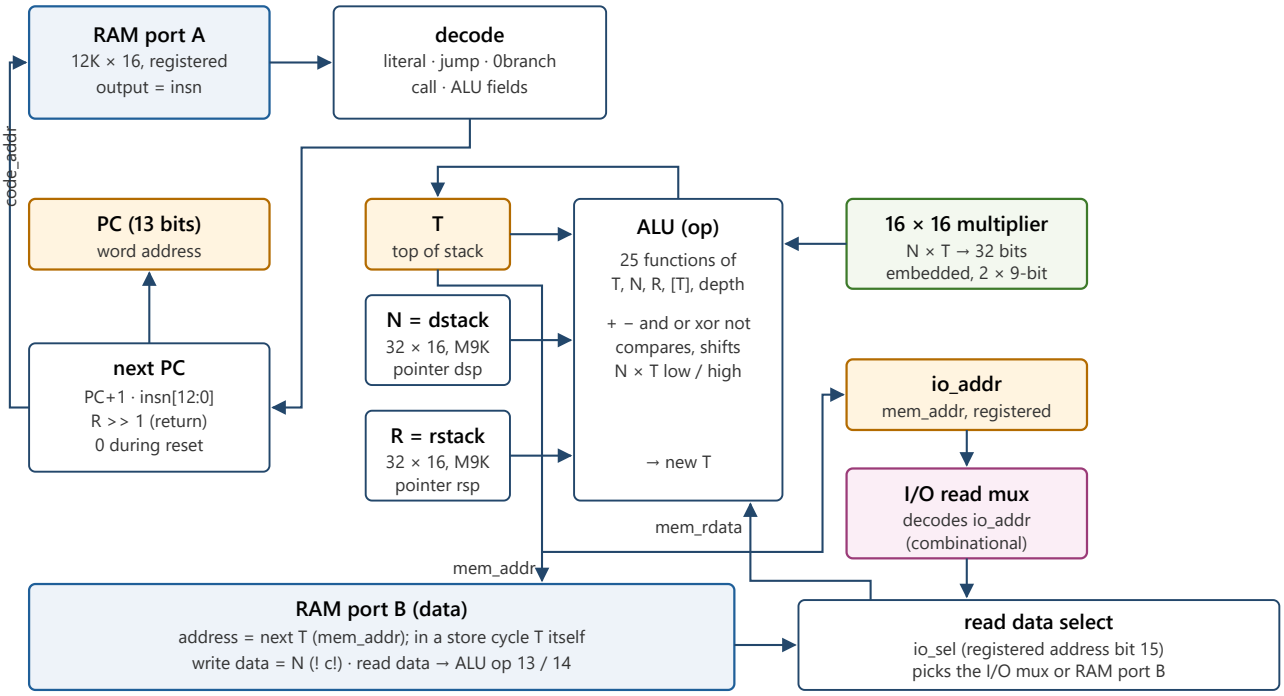
Clock	Setup slack	Hold slack	Fmax
c1, CPU clock, 48 MHz (20.833 ns)	1.545 ns	0.340 ns	51.85 MHz
c2, DDS clock, 192 MHz (5.208 ns)	1.168 ns	0.485 ns	247.52 MHz

At 0 °C the slacks are 2.826 ns and 1.537 ns. All constraints are met. The CPU clock's worst paths are still the stack RAM → multiplier → ALU → next-T paths of section 2.1, now ending at the RAM's and `io_addr`'s address registers. The 192 MHz domain holds only the 32-bit phase adder and the handshake.

Quartus reports critical warning 16248 for pins next to the ADC inputs (LED1..LED7, the UART, the flash pins and D4): switching I/O there may disturb the ADC's sampling. The pins are fixed by the board; `build.ps1` filters the warning.

3 The HF16 CPU

`rtl/hf16_cpu.v`, 171 lines of Verilog, the same file as in ZYNQ-FORTH. HF16 follows the scheme of the J1 Forth CPU (James Bowman, 2010): a dual-stack machine with literal, jump, conditional-branch, call and ALU instructions, where one ALU instruction can change the top of stack, move both stack pointers, store to memory and return, all in one clock.



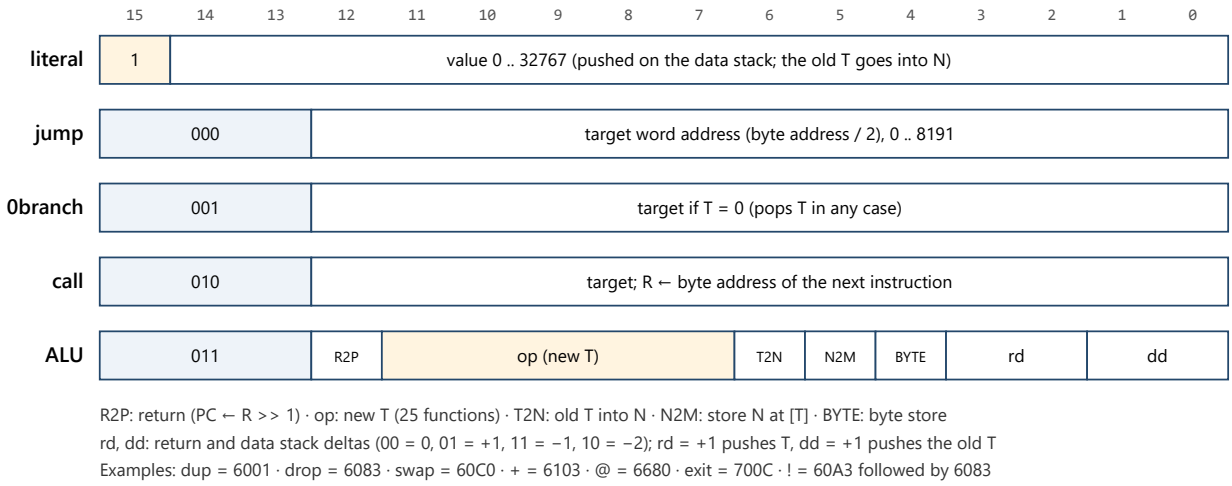
The I/O multiplexer works from io_addr, one clock after the address, like the RAM's own address register: this is what allows 48 MHz.

3.1 Machine model

- **Cells** are 16 bits. Addresses are byte addresses; a cell is stored little-endian and must be even-aligned (the RAM ignores address bit 0 for cell accesses).
- **Instructions** are 16 bits, one per cell. The program counter is a 13-bit *word* address, so code runs from the first 16 KB (0x0000–0x3FFF) only.
- **Data stack:** the top item T is a register (`st0`); the items below it (N is the top one) are a 32-entry RAM addressed by the pointer `dsp`.
- **Return stack:** a 32-entry RAM addressed by `rsp`; R is its top entry. It holds return addresses as **byte** addresses (the PC is R >> 1), the loop index and limit of `do … loop`, and whatever `>r` puts there.
- **Memory:** 24 KB of RAM from address 0 (data accesses reach 0x0000–0x5FFF), I/O registers from 0x8000 (address bit 15 set).
- **Speed:** one instruction per 48 MHz clock (20.8 ns), every instruction, including the multiply and the loads. There are no stalls on the MAX1000: the CPU's `stall` input, which the ARM uses on the Zynq to pause it, is tied to 0.

The stacks live inside the CPU, not in RAM: there is no stack pointer a program could read as an address, and both stacks wrap around silently after 32 entries. The kernel checks the depth after every word it interprets (section 5.6).

3.2 Instruction formats



R2P: return (PC ← R >> 1) · op: new T (25 functions) · T2N: old T into N · N2M: store N at [T] · BYTE: byte store
rd, dd: return and data stack deltas (00 = 0, 01 = +1, 11 = −1, 10 = −2); rd = +1 pushes T, dd = +1 pushes the old T
Examples: dup = 6001 · drop = 6083 · swap = 60C0 · + = 6103 · @ = 6680 · exit = 700C · ! = 60A3 followed by 6083

Bits 15..13	Instruction	Effect
`1xx`	literal	push `insn[14:0]` (0 to 32,767)
`000`	jump	PC ← `insn[12:0]`
`001`	0branch	pop T; if it was 0, PC ← `insn[12:0]`
`010`	call	push the byte address of the next instruction on the return stack; PC ← `insn[12:0]`
`011`	ALU	the fields below, all in one clock

A literal from 32,768 to 65,535 (a negative number, or an I/O address) does not fit 15 bits; the compilers emit its complement followed by `invert` (two instructions). `$8000 @` is therefore three instructions: `literal 32767`, `invert`, `@`.

ALU instruction fields:

Bits	Field	Effect
12	R2P	return: PC ← R >> 1 (combined with rd = −1 to pop the address)
11..7	op	the new T (table in 3.3)
6	T2N	write the old T into N (`swap`; implied by a data push)
5	N2M	store N at address T (RAM or I/O)
4	BYTE	the store writes one byte (`c!`)
3..2	rd	return stack delta: 00 = 0, 01 = +1 (pushes T), 11 = −1, 10 = −2
1..0	dd	data stack delta: 00 = 0, 01 = +1 (pushes the old T into N), 11 = −1, 10 = −2

3.3 ALU functions

op	new T	op	new T
0	T	13	the cell at [T]
1	N	14	the byte at [T]

op	new T	op	new T
2	N + T	15	data stack depth
3	N and T	16	N − T
4	N or T	17	T + 1
5	N xor T	18	T − 1
6	not T	19	T = 0 (−1 or 0)
7	N = T (−1 or 0)	20	T < 0 (−1 or 0)
8	N < T, signed	21	N × T, low 16 bits
9	N < T, unsigned	22	T >> 1, arithmetic
10	N >> T, logical	23	−T
11	N << T	24	N × T unsigned, high 16 bits (for `um*`)
12	R	25..31	T (unused)

Details:

- **Shifts** by 16 or more give 0: the hardware tests `T[15:4] ≠ 0` and otherwise uses `T[3:0]` as the count. There is no arithmetic shift by T; `2/` (op 22) shifts by one.
- **The multiplier** is a single unsigned 16 × 16 → 32-bit product of N and T on an embedded multiplier. Op 21 takes its low half, which is also the low half of the signed product, so `*` serves signed and unsigned numbers; op 24 takes the high half, from which `um*` builds a 32-bit product in two instructions. The product is combinational: one clock.
- **Byte loads** pick the high or low byte of the cell at [T] with `T[0]` (little-endian).
- **Depth** is the 5-bit pointer `dsp`, the number of items on the stack. After an underflow it wraps to 31 and below, which the kernel uses to detect underflow.

3.4 Primitives

Every Forth primitive is one ALU instruction (two for the stores). The encodings, as `tools/hf16.py` defines them:

Word	Encoding	Fields
`dup`	`6001`	T ← T, dd +1
`drop`	`6083`	T ← N, dd −1
`swap`	`60C0`	T ← N, T2N
`over`	`6081`	T ← N, dd +1
`nip`	`6003`	T ← T, dd −1
`>r`	`6087`	T ← N, rd +1 (pushes T), dd −1
`r>`	`660D`	T ← R, rd −1, dd +1
`r@` (and `i`)	`6601`	T ← R, dd +1
`+`	`6103`	T ← N + T, dd −1
`-`	`6803`	T ← N − T, dd −1

Word	Encoding	Fields
`and` / `or` / `xor`	`6183` / `6203` / `6283`	dd −1
`=` / `<` / `u<`	`6383` / `6403` / `6483`	dd −1
`rshift` / `lshift`	`6503` / `6583`	dd −1
`*`	`6A83`	T ← N × T low, dd −1
`(um*)`	`6C03`	T ← N × T high, dd −1 (cross-compiler only)
`invert` / `negate`	`6300` / `6B80`	
`1+` / `1-` / `2/`	`6880` / `6900` / `6B00`	
`0=` / `0<`	`6980` / `6A00`	
`@` / `c@`	`6680` / `6700`	T ← [T]
`!`	`60A3 6083`	store N at [T], T ← N, dd −1; then `drop`
`c!`	`60B3 6083`	the same with BYTE
`depth`	`6781`	T ← depth, dd +1
`exit`	`700C`	R2P, rd −1

Because a data push writes the old T into N and a pop takes N into T, the "new T" of a pop is N and the value consumed is the old T: `+` is "T ← N + T, pop".

3.5 Memory ports and timing

HF16 sits between the two ports of a synchronous dual-port RAM whose outputs are registered (the M9K's read data appears one clock after the address). Two tricks give it single-cycle instructions with such a RAM:

- **Code port.** `code_addr` is the *next* PC, computed combinationally from the current instruction (PC + 1, a jump or call target, a taken 0branch, or R >> 1 on a return). The RAM registers it at the clock edge, and the instruction at the new PC is on `insn` during the next cycle. There is no fetch stage: a jump, call or return costs nothing extra. During reset `code_addr` is 0, so the first instruction after a reset is the jump at address 0.
- **Data port.** `mem_addr` is the *next* T. Whatever T becomes at the end of this instruction, the RAM is reading the cell at that address meanwhile, so in the next instruction `mem_rdata` already holds [T]. That is why `@` (op 13: T ← [T]) takes one clock: the load was started speculatively by the instruction before it.

The store hazard. A store needs the data port to address the *current* T, so in a store cycle `mem_addr` is T instead of the next T, and the port writes N there. The instruction after a store therefore finds the stored address's data on `mem_rdata` (and the RAM is declared `no_rw_check`, so what it reads during the write is not even defined), not [T]. The rule, kept by both compilers: the instruction directly after a store does not read memory (op 13 or 14). `!` and `c!` end with a plain `drop`. The cost is one instruction per store, and nothing to schedule anywhere else.

I/O reads with side effects. Because loads are started speculatively, the I/O decoder "reads" a register whenever T happens to hold its address. All reads are therefore free of side effects except one: `$8000`, which pops the RX FIFO. It pops only when an instruction actually consumes [T]: the CPU's `mem_rd` output is set by an ALU instruction with op 13 or 14, and the top level qualifies it with the full address in T (`rx_pop = mem_rd && T == 16'h8000`). An alias of `$8000` (such as `$8100`) reads the byte without taking it.

Why the I/O read multiplexer sits on `io_addr`. RAM and I/O behave the same way for the CPU: the value of an address arrives in the cycle after the address was formed. The RAM does this with its address register. The I/O side copies the idea: `io_addr` registers `mem_addr` every clock, and the read multiplexer decodes `io_addr` combinationally in the next cycle; `io_sel`, the registered address bit 15, then chooses between the multiplexer and RAM port B. Stores are still decoded from `mem_addr` (which equals T in a store cycle). This keeps all I/O decoding off the CPU's longest path and is what made 48 MHz possible (section 2.1). The cost is one register of 16 bits; the CPU sees no difference.

Returns use byte addresses, so `>r` and `r>` can move return addresses as ordinary numbers: `execute` is `>r exit` (push the execution token and "return" into it), and `(.")` reads the inline string after its call by taking its own return address, skipping the string and pushing the address back.

3.6 Next-state logic

For each instruction class the next state is (from `hf16_cpu.v`):

Class	T	Data stack	Return stack	PC
literal	value	push old T	–	PC + 1
jump	–	–	–	target
0branch	N	pop	–	target if T = 0, else PC + 1
call	–	–	push (PC + 1) × 2	target
ALU	`op` result	`dsp += dd`; write old T if T2N or dd = +1	`rsp += rd`; write T if rd = +1	R >> 1 if R2P, else PC + 1

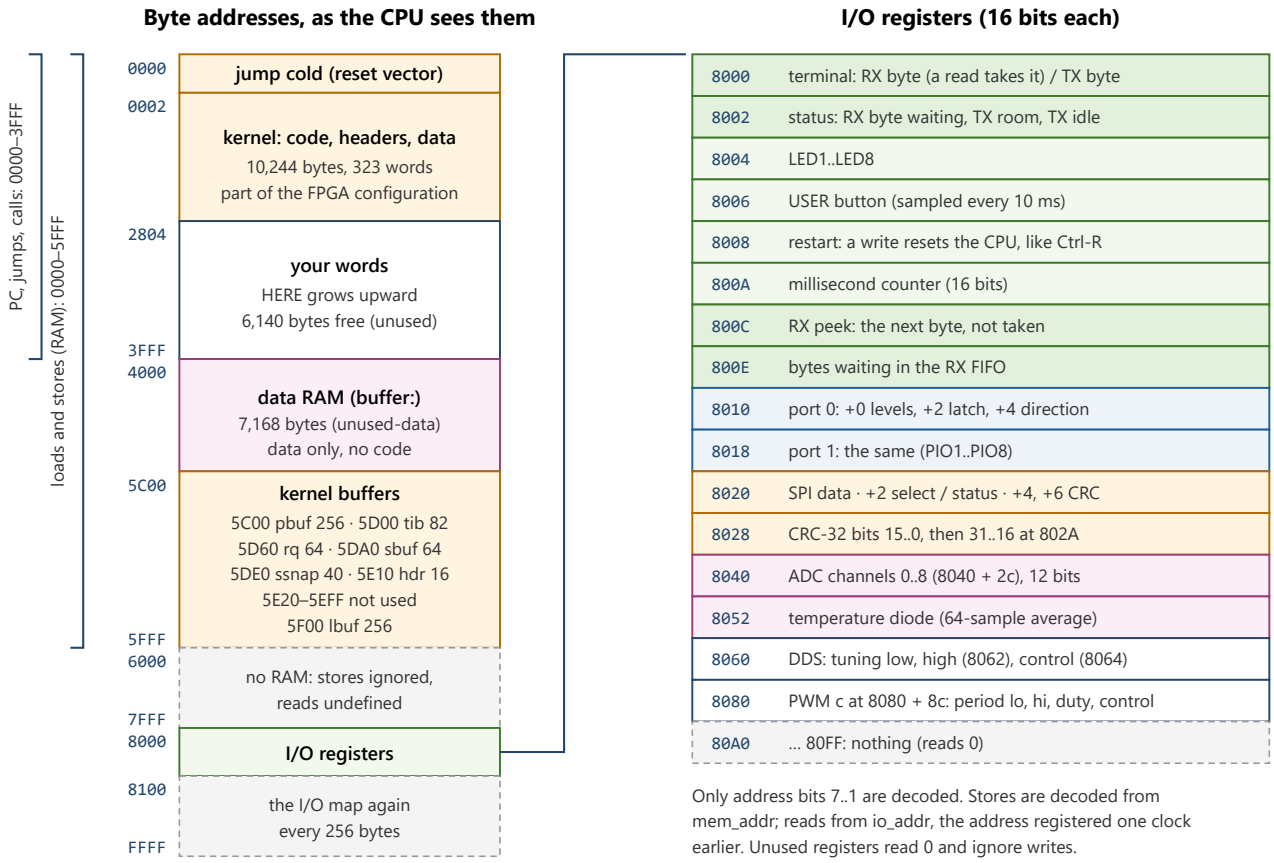
The stack RAMs are written at the *new* pointer: a push increments the pointer and writes the old top there in the same clock. The store, if N2M is set, writes N to address T in the same clock as everything else.

3.7 The stacks in M9K

On the Zynq the two 32-entry stacks are LUT RAM. The MAX 10 has no LUT RAM, so Quartus maps each stack into one M9K block (512 bits of its 9,216 used), which costs two M9K blocks but saves several hundred logic elements of flip-flops and multiplexers.

That works because of how the CPU reads them: `N = dstack[dsp]` and `R = rstack[rsp]` are asynchronous reads, but `dsp` and `rsp` are registers fed by `dsp_n` and `rsp_n`. Quartus moves the read address register into the M9K (its address register latches `dsp_n` at the same edge as `dsp`), so the M9K's registered output is exactly N in the next cycle. A push writes `dstack[dsp_n]` at the same edge at which the read address becomes `dsp_n`, a read-during-write of the same entry; Quartus adds a small bypass multiplexer for it (two logic levels behind the M9K, visible in the timing path of section 2.1).

4 Memory and I/O



4.1 RAM

The RAM is 12K × 16 bits, 24 KB, inferred in `max1000_forth.v` as two arrays of 12,288 × 8 bits, `ram_lo` (the low byte of each cell) and `ram_hi` (the high byte), each in 12 M9K blocks. The M9K could do byte enables, but two byte-wide halves are simpler to infer reliably:

- **Port A** fetches instructions: address `code_addr` (13 bits, so only the first 8K cells, 16 KB, are ever fetched), registered output `insn = {hi_a, lo_a}`.
- **Port B** is the CPU's data port: address `mem_addr[14:1]`, read data `{hi_b, lo_b}`.
- **Byte stores** write one half: `we_lo` for an even address, `we_hi` for an odd one, with the byte replicated onto both halves' data inputs. A cell store writes both.
- **Stores to 0x6000–0x7FFF are ignored** (`ram_store` excludes `mem_addr[14:13] = 11`); reads there return no defined value. Address bit 15 selects I/O.
- **Initialization:** both halves are loaded with `$readmemh` from `build/forth_lo.hex` and `build/forth_hi.hex`, the kernel image as `tools/hf16.py` writes it (section 7.3).

Code and data share the RAM: the Forth compiler, running on HF16, writes new code with ordinary stores, and the code port fetches it in the next instruction. **The 16 KB code limit** follows from the 13-bit word addresses in jumps, calls and the PC: a colon definition must lie below 0x4000. The kernel takes 10,244 bytes of it, leaving 6,140 bytes for typed definitions. The 8 KB above it (0x4000–0x5FFF) can be read and written but not executed;

the kernel hands out 0x4000–0x5BFF as **data RAM** with `buffer:` and keeps its own buffers in 0x5C00–0x5FFF (section 5.2). Nothing checks that the dictionary stays below 0x4000: a definition that grows past it lands in the data RAM, where it cannot run.

4.2 The I/O read path

I/O registers are 16 bits wide, at even addresses from `$8000`. Only address bits 7..1 are decoded, so the 128 registers repeat every 256 bytes up to `$FFFF`; unused registers read 0 and ignore writes.

- **Stores** are decoded from `mem_addr`, which is T during a store: `io_store = mem_we && mem_addr[15]`, then per block (`io_pwm`, `io_dds`, `io_spi`, `io_gpio`, the LED register, the restart register `$8008`, the TX FIFO push at `$8000`). The write data is N (`mem_wdata`).
- **Reads** are decoded from `io_addr`, the address of the previous clock. A priority multiplexer looks at `io_addr[7:4]`: `$8040–$805F` the ADC codes (slot 0..9, higher slots 0), `$8060–$807F` the DDS, `$8080–$809F` the PWM channels, `$8020–$802F` the SPI master and CRC, `$8010–$801F` the two pin ports, `$8000–$800F` the UART, LEDs, button and timer. The peripheral modules (`pwm`, `dds`, `spi_flash`) therefore have two register selects: one from `mem_addr` for stores and one from `io_addr` for reads.
- **The data port's read data** is `mem_rdata = io_sel ? io_rdata : {hi_b, lo_b}`, with `io_sel` the registered address bit 15.

4.3 I/O map

Address	Read	Write
`$8000`	next received byte (pops the RX FIFO)	send a byte (pushes the TX FIFO)
`$8002`	bit 0 = a received byte is waiting, bit 1 = the TX FIFO has room, bit 2 = TX idle (FIFO empty and the transmitter done)	–
`$8004`	LED1..LED8 (bits 0..7)	the same
`$8006`	bit 0 = USER button pressed (sampled every 10 ms)	–
`$8008`	–	any value: reset the CPU (as Ctrl-R)
`$800A`	millisecond counter, 16 bits, wraps	–
`$800C`	next received byte without taking it (peek)	–
`$800E`	bytes waiting in the RX FIFO (0..8192)	–
`$8010 + 8p`	port p (0, 1): pin levels, synchronized	–
`$8012 + 8p`	port p: output latch	the same
`$8014 + 8p`	port p: direction, 1 = output (0 after reset)	the same
`$8020`	SPI: the byte received last	SPI: send a byte (starts an 8-bit exchange; ignored while busy)
`$8022`	bit 0 = flash selected, bit 1 = busy, bit 2 = accelerometer selected	bit 0 = select the flash, bit 1 = select the accelerometer
`$8024`	–	reset the CRC
`$8026`	–	add the low byte to the CRC

Address	Read	Write
`$8028`, `$802A`	CRC-32 bits 15..0, 31..16	–
`$8040 + 2c`	ADC channel c (0..8), 12-bit code	–
`$8052`	temperature diode, 12-bit code (64-sample average)	–
`$8060`	DDS: tuning word, low 16 bits	the same (held until the high half is written)
`$8062`	DDS: tuning word, high 16 bits	the same (takes both halves)
`$8064`	DDS: bit 15 on, bit 14 busy (a change not yet taken over), bits 5..0 pin	bit 15 on, bits 5..0 pin
`$8080 + 8c`	PWM channel c (0..3): period, low 16 bits	the same (held until the high half is written)
`$8082 + 8c`	PWM channel c: period, high 16 bits (48 MHz clocks per cycle, at least 2)	the same (takes both halves)
`$8084 + 8c`	PWM channel c: duty in 1/65536 of the period, `$FFFF` = always high	the same
`$8086 + 8c`	PWM channel c: bit 15 on, bits 5..0 pin	the same

4.4 UART and FIFOs

`rtl/uart.v` holds an 8N1 transmitter and receiver with `CLKS_PER_BIT` = (48,000,000 + 57,600) / 115,200 = 417:

- **Receiver:** the RX pin passes a two-flop synchronizer. A low level starts a byte; the counter waits half a bit and checks that the start bit is still low (a shorter pulse is a glitch and ignored), then samples the eight data bits LSB first in the middle of each bit, 417 clocks apart. The byte is delivered (`valid` for one clock) only if the stop bit is high; a framing error drops it silently.
- **Transmitter:** takes a byte when `start` is high, shifts out start bit, eight data bits and the stop bit, 417 clocks each, and reports `busy` meanwhile.

`rtl/fifo_bram.v` is a single-clock first-word-fall-through FIFO in M9K. `dout` always shows the oldest byte while the FIFO is not empty; a pop advances the read pointer and reads the next entry in the same clock. A pushed byte becomes visible two clocks later (the write pointer is copied into a "visible" pointer one clock after the write, so the synchronous RAM read has completed). `count` is the number of visible bytes. A push into a full FIFO is dropped.

- **RX FIFO, 8 KB** (8 M9K). It is that large for the saved source: while `store` erases a 4 KB sector of the serial flash (about 45 ms) the bytes keep arriving, about 520 of them, and the FIFO absorbs them (section 5.12). It also lets the app queue up to 4 KB of text (chapter 8). A byte 0x12 is never pushed (section 4.5).
- **TX FIFO, 1 KB** (1 M9K). A register `utx_start` pops a byte into the transmitter whenever the FIFO is not empty and the transmitter is idle. Forth's `emit` waits while the FIFO is full, so output is never lost; a line of up to 1 KB goes out without Forth waiting.

The UART receiver and transmitter are reset only by the power-on reset; the FIFOs, the CPU and the peripherals also by Ctrl-R. A byte in flight is therefore never cut by a restart.

4.5 Ctrl-R and restart

The top level watches the receiver: `restart <= (urx_valid && urx_data == 8'h12) || sw_restart`, a one-clock pulse, and `cpu_rst = sys_rst | restart`. `sw_restart` is a store to `$8008`, which the kernel uses for the `restart` request.

Reset by `cpu_rst` (Ctrl-R, `$8008`, power-on)	Not reset
the CPU: PC = 0, T = 0, both stack pointers 0	the RAM: the kernel image and everything typed stay
both FIFOs: typed-ahead input and unsent output are discarded	the millisecond counter and the button sampler
the LEDs (all off), the pin latches and directions (all inputs)	the UART receiver and transmitter
all PWM channels off (all their registers 0)	the ADC scanner (it runs on the power-on reset)
the DDS off (tuning and control 0)	the PLL
the SPI master: both selects released, CRC reset	

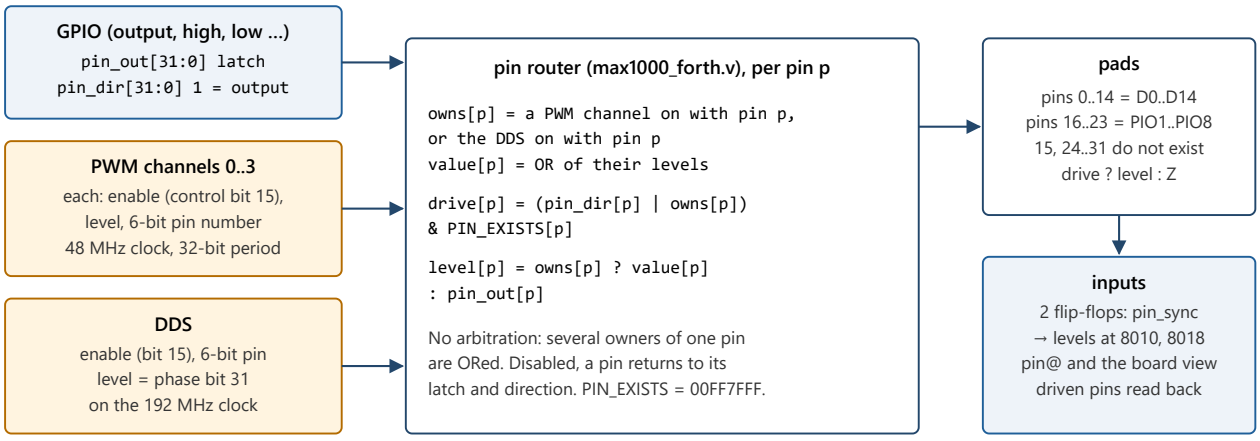
The byte 0x12 is not pushed into the RX FIFO (`push = urx_valid && urx_data != 8'h12`), so Forth never sees it. The reset clears the FIFO in the same clock, which removes whatever was queued before the 0x12; bytes after it (the app's ESC that skips the saved source) arrive in an empty FIFO. Since the check is in hardware, Ctrl-R works whatever the CPU does, including a tight loop that never polls anything. The flip side: a byte 0x12 can never be data. The terminal and the service protocol carry only text, and the app and `mforth.py` send printable ASCII and CR only.

The **power-on reset** `sys_rst` holds everything until the PLL reports lock and an 8-bit counter has run 255 more CPU clocks. The board's **RESET** button is the MAX 10's nCONFIG pin: it reloads the whole configuration from the internal flash (logic and RAM image), which is why it cannot serve as a user input.

4.6 LEDs, button and millisecond timer

- **LEDs:** an 8-bit register, written at `$8004`, read back there; LED1 is bit 0. Cleared by `cpu_rst`; `cold` turns LED1 on as a sign of life.
- **Timer:** a divider counts 48,000 clocks (`MS_DIV = CLK_HZ / 1000`) and increments the 16-bit millisecond counter at `$800A`, which wraps after 65.5 s. `ms` waits by comparing signed differences, so it is correct across the wrap for waits up to 32,767 ms.
- **Button:** the USER button passes a two-flop synchronizer and is sampled every tenth millisecond tick into `btn_state` (1 = pressed, since the pin is low while pressed). That debounces it: a bounce shorter than 10 ms cannot produce two changes. Until its first sample, 10 ms after configuration, the button reads "not pressed", which matters for the autostart check (section 5.12).

4.7 Pins and pin ownership



Pull-ups: none by default; scripts/build.ps1 -PullUps sets weak pull-ups on D0..D14 and PIO1..PIO8 in the configuration.
Unused FPGA pins are reserved as inputs with weak pull-ups (RESERVE_ALL_UNUSED_PINS_WEAK_PULLUP in scripts/build.tcl).

The digital pins form two 16-bit ports in 32-bit registers: `pin_out` (latch), `pin_dir` (direction, 1 = output) and `pin_sync` (levels through a two-flop synchronizer). Pin n is bit n mod 16 of port n / 16:

Pin numbers	Port bits	Connector	FPGA pins
0..14	port 0 bits 0..14	header D0..D14	H8 K10 H5 H4 J1 J2 L12 J12 J13 K11 K12 J10 H10 H13 G12
16..23	port 1 bits 0..7	Pmod PIO_01..PIO_08	M3 L3 M2 M1 N3 N2 K2 K1

Pin 15 and pins 24..31 do not exist: `PIN_EXISTS = 32'h00FF_7FFF` masks them, so they read 0, ignore writes and are never driven; the Forth word `pin` refuses them. All pins are inputs after reset.

Ownership. A PWM channel or the DDS that is switched on *owns* the pin its control register names. For each of the 32 pin positions the top level computes, combinationally:

```
pwm_owns[p]  = any enabled PWM channel, or the enabled DDS, names pin p
pwm_value[p] = OR of their levels
pin_drive    = (pin_dir | pwm_owns) & PIN_EXISTS
pin_level    = (pin_out & ~pwm_owns) | (pwm_value & pwm_owns)
```

An owned pin is driven with the generator's level whatever its direction bit says; switched off, the pin returns to its latch and direction. Several owners of one pin are ORed: the hardware does not arbitrate, and the MAX1000 kernel keeps no ownership table either (unlike ZYNQ-FPGA-FORTH32). The levels of driven pins are read back through the synchronizer like inputs, so `pin@` on a PWM pin shows the waveform, and the `board` answer reports owned pins as driven (section 5.13).

Pull-ups. By default the pins have none, so an open input reads at random. `scripts/build.ps1 -PullUps` sets the MAX 10's weak pull-ups on D0..D14 and PIO1..PIO8 in the configuration; Forth cannot switch them. The option is off by default because the bench has LEDs with 1 kΩ to ground on D3..D5, which a pull-up keeps faintly lit while the pin is an input. Pins the design does not use at all are reserved as inputs with weak pull-ups (`RESERVE_ALL_UNUSED_PINS_WEAK_PULLUP`).

4.8 PWM

`rtl/pwm.v` is ZYNQ-FORTH's PWM block with one change: separate register selects for reads (`rd_ch`, `rd_reg` from `io_addr`) and stores (from `mem_addr`). Four channels, each with:

- a **32-bit period** in 48 MHz clocks, written in two halves (the low half is held in `lo_hold` until the high half arrives, so a period never changes halfway); values below 2 count as 2;
- a **16-bit duty**, the fraction of the period in 1/65536; `$FFFF` means always high;
- a **control** register: bit 15 on, bits 5..0 the pin.

Each channel counts from 0 to period − 1 and is high for the first ⌊period × duty / 65536⌋ clocks. The 32 × 16 product is pipelined in two register stages (two 18 × 18 multipliers per channel, 16 multiplier elements for the four). New period and duty values are taken at the end of the running cycle, so no pulse is ever cut short; while a channel is off it keeps its counter at 0 with the first cycle's level prepared, so enabling starts a fresh cycle at once. Frequency range: 24 MHz (period 2) down to 0.0112 Hz (period 2^{32} − 1). All registers read back what was written; a CPU reset clears them, which turns every channel off.

4.9 DDS

`rtl/dds.v` (release 1.1, after ZYNQ-FPGA-FORTH32's DDS) is a 32-bit phase accumulator on PLL output c2, 192 MHz. Its top bit is a square wave: f = tuning × 192 MHz / 2^{32}, in steps of 0.0447 Hz. Edges fall on the 5.21 ns grid of the 192 MHz clock, so a period that does not divide 192 MHz evenly alternates between two lengths one step apart. The kernel allows up to 65.535 MHz; above some tens of MHz the pin and its wiring limit what arrives.

The registers live on the CPU clock: the tuning word (low half held until the high half is written, as with the PWM period) and the control word (bit 15 on, bits 5..0 the pin). A **toggle handshake** carries them to the 192 MHz side:

1. A write of the high half or of the control register flips `req` (if no request is in flight).
2. The generator side passes `req` through two flip-flops, detects the change, copies the tuning word and the on bit (both stable, because the CPU side does not send again before the acknowledgement) and returns the toggle as `ack`.
3. The CPU side passes `ack` through two flip-flops; while `req ≠ ack`, the change is busy.
4. A change written while one is in flight sets `dirty`, and the request is sent again after the acknowledgement, so the last value always arrives.

Bit 14 of the control register reads "busy or dirty"; the kernel's `dds-sync` waits for it to clear. Turning the DDS on (or off) restarts the phase at 0; a new tuning word while it runs keeps the phase going, so a frequency change has no glitch. The output bit is registered on the 192 MHz clock. Like a PWM channel the DDS owns its pin while on (ORed with a PWM channel on the same pin), and a CPU reset turns it off: the reset clears both registers and sends them across like a write.

The DDS uses 148 logic elements in its own unit (about 200 with its pin routing and read path) and no RAM; the 32-bit adder meets 192 MHz with 1.17 ns of slack. Release 1.1 also narrowed the ADC's read decode to `$8040–$805F` to make room for the DDS at `$8060`.

4.10 ADC and temperature diode

`rtl/adc_scan.v` drives Intel's **Modular ADC control core** (`altera_modular_adc_control`). It is instantiated directly from the Quartus installation's IP folder, without Platform Designer: `build.tcl` adds its six Verilog files,

and `adc_scan.v` sets the parameters the IP editor would: ADC clock divider for 1 MSPS from the 10 MHz PLL output, the temperature sensor's clock divider for 50 kSPS, the internal reference (on the single-supply 10M08SA that is VCCA, 3.3 V), and `analog_input_pin_mask` = 65,791 (`0x100FF`: CH1..CH8 in bits 0..7, CH0 in bit 16). The core needs that mask as an integer; a sized Verilog vector is not accepted.

The scanner keeps the core's command interface busy (`cmd_valid` always high):

- **Channels CH8 down to CH0**, each converted **four times in a row** as one packet (start-of-packet on the first command, end-of-packet on the fourth). Only the result flagged with end-of-packet is stored. The reason: a high-impedance source, such as the bench potentiometer, does not recharge the sample capacitor in one 1 µs conversion after a different channel, and a floating input simply shows the previous channel's charge. With four conversions the fourth has settled.
- **Then one temperature (TSD) command** (channel 17 of the core). For it the core switches the ADC into temperature mode and back by itself and returns a running average of the last 64 samples (its averaging FIFO is the one M9K of the ADC unit).

The results land in a 10 × 12-bit register (`codes`): slots 0..8 = CH0..CH8, slot 9 = the TSD. A CPU read at `$8040 + 2c` picks a slot through `io_addr[4:1]` and never waits; it gets the newest code of that channel.

The header labels do not follow the ADC channel numbers. From the Quartus pin report, and confirmed with a potentiometer on AIN3:

Header	AIN	AIN0	AIN1	AIN2	AIN3	AIN4	AIN5	AIN6	AIN7
FPGA pin	D2 (ANAIN1)	E1	C2	C1	D1	E3	E4	F1	B1
ADC channel	0	8	2	5	1	3	4	7	6
`adc@` input	8	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7

The kernel's table `ain` maps the header input numbers (`adc@`, `mv@`) to channels; `adc-ch@` reads a channel directly. The order was found with the potentiometer: before the four-fold conversion its value leaked into the channel converted next, and the open inputs copied their predecessor's charge, which hid which input was really wired.

Temperature. The TSD code falls as the chip warms. Intel's code-to-temperature table could not be obtained while the kernel was written, so `temp@` interpolates linearly between two of its points, −40 °C = 3798 and 96 °C = 3510, and gives tenths of a degree; it is approximate. The board read about 31.7 °C on the bench. `temp-code@` returns the raw code.

4.11 SPI master, serial flash, accelerometer and CRC-32

`rtl/spi_flash.v` is a byte-wide SPI master shared by two devices, each on its own pins: the clock and data-out signals go to both, data-in comes from the selected one (`miso_sel = cs2_n ? F_DO : SEN_SDO`). Forth drives the select bits and every command byte; the hardware only shifts.

- **Timing:** SPI mode 0. Each half period of SCK lasts three CPU clocks, so SCK = 48 MHz / 6 = 8 MHz, and an exchange of 8 bits takes 48 clocks (1 µs). MISO is sampled three clocks (62.5 ns) after the falling edge that changed it, as SCK rises; MOSI changes at the falling edge. 8 MHz is chosen for the accelerometer, which allows at most 10 MHz; the flash would allow far more.
- **Registers:** a store to `$8020` (ignored while busy) loads the shift register and starts the exchange; `$8022` bit 1 reads busy; afterwards `$8020` holds the byte received. Writing `$8022` sets both chip selects at once: bit 0 = flash (F_S low), bit 1 = accelerometer (SEN_CS low).

- **CRC-32 unit:** the standard reflected CRC-32 (polynomial 0xEDB88320, initial value and final XOR all ones), the same as zlib's and the one the app computes. A store to `$8026` adds one byte in one clock (the eight bit steps are unrolled); `$8024` resets it; `$8028` and `$802A` read the two halves of the finished (inverted) value. On the board the unit gave 0x66D2DB21 for `examples/bench.fs`, as zlib does.

The **Winbond W25Q64** (JEDEC ID EF 40 17) has 8 MB in 4 KB sectors, 64 KB blocks and 256-byte pages; it is blank on delivery. The kernel uses the commands 03 read, 02 page program, 06 write enable, 05 read status (bit 0 busy), 20 4 KB sector erase, D8 64 KB block erase and 9F JEDEC ID.

The **ST LIS3DH** speaks SPI with a first byte holding the register address, bit 7 = read and bit 6 = auto-increment. `accel-on` (run by `cold`) writes CTRL_REG1 (`$20`) = `$57` (100 Hz, X, Y and Z on) and CTRL_REG4 (`$23`) = `$88` (block data update, high resolution, ±2 g). `accel@` reads OUT_X_L..OUT_Z_H (`$28..$2D`) in one burst (`$E8` = read + auto-increment + `$28`) and shifts each left-justified 12-bit value right by 4, giving 1 mg per digit. WHO_AM_I (`$0F`) answers `$33` (`accel?`). The board lying flat reads z ≈ +1024 mg.

5 The Forth kernel

The kernel is one Forth source file, `forth/kernel.fs` (766 lines). It compiles to a 10,244-byte image (5,122 cells) with 323 words, and everything a user meets is in it: the interpreter, the compiler, number conversion, the board words, the saved source and the answers to the app. About a third of the words are internal.

5.1 Two compilers that produce the same code

The kernel is written in Forth but has to exist before any Forth runs, so it is built in two stages:

- **At build time**, `tools/hf16.py` reads `kernel.fs` on the PC. Its compiler understands what the kernel needs and no more: outside definitions numbers, `: :inline variable constant create allot , c, immediate` and comments; inside definitions the primitives (compiled inline), calls, literals and the control structures `if else then begin until again while repeat do loop +loop i unloop recurse ." s" [char] ['] [op]`. Calls to words defined further down are allowed and patched at the end. It sets cell 0 to a jump to `cold`, stores the final `dp` and `latest` into those variables and into their copies `dp0` and `latest0`, computes the image's checksum into `kcheck`, and writes the RAM image.
- **At run time**, the kernel carries its own compiler (`:`, `;`, `literal`, `if`, ...) as ordinary Forth words. It compiles everything typed later, and the saved source.

Both produce the same kind of code: inlined primitives, calls, literals and branches. The cross-compiler adds two optimizations the target compiler does not make: a definition's last call becomes a jump (tail call), and a final ALU instruction without a return or a return-stack change gets the return folded in (R2P and rd = −1), unless the end of the definition is a branch target. `: rot >r swap r> swap ;` is therefore four instructions in the kernel, the last `swap` returning; typed at the terminal it would be five.

`[op]` is a host word that compiles a primitive's instruction as a literal number; the kernel uses it where it must *emit* an instruction rather than execute one, as in `: exit [op] exit , ; immediate`. `s"` exists only in the cross-compiler (the kernel uses it for the request names); the target compiler has no `s"`.

5.2 Memory layout

Address	Content
`$0000`	jump to `cold` (the reset vector)
`$0002`–`$2803`	the kernel: headers, code and variables, 10,244 bytes with the vector
`$2804`	HERE after a cold start: new definitions grow upward
`$3FFF`	the end of the code space: 6,140 bytes free (`unused`)
`$4000`–`$5BFF`	data RAM handed out by `buffer:` (`dp2`, 7,168 bytes, `unused-data`)
`$5C00`–`$5FFF`	the kernel's buffers, below
`$6000`–`$7FFF`	no RAM

Address	Name	Size	Use
`$5C00`	`pbuf`	256	one flash page while a source is stored

Address	Name	Size	Use
`$5D00`	`tib`	82 (80 used)	the input line
`$5D60`	`rq`	64 (63 used)	a service request line
`$5DA0`	`sbuf`	64	`.s` parks the stack here (32 cells)
`$5DE0`	`ssnap`	40	the data stack at the last prompt, 20 cells, for the `stack` request
`$5E10`	`hdr`	16	the saved source's header
`$5E20`–`$5EFF`	–	224	not used, not handed out
`$5F00`	`lbuf`	256	the piece of saved source being interpreted

The buffers are constants, not allotted space, so they cost no dictionary space and survive any amount of typed code. The variables (`dp`, `latest`, `state`, `base`, `fsrc` …) are in the kernel image in the code space, as `variable` makes them.

5.3 Dictionary headers

```
header:  link      cell: address of the previous header (0 ends the list)
         count     byte: bits 4..0 = name length, $80 immediate, $40 hidden, $20 inline
         name      the name's bytes, padded with a zero to an even address
xt:      code      the word's machine code
```

Words are found newest first by following the links from `latest` (`find-name`); a hidden word is skipped, and names are compared without regard to case (`same?` through `upper`). `name>xt` is the header address + 3 + length, aligned. A `create`d word's code is a literal of its data address and an `exit`, so its data starts 4 bytes after its execution token; a `variable` is a `create` with one cell, a `constant` a literal and an `exit`. Names may be up to 31 characters.

5.4 The layers

Section of `kernel.fs`	Bytes	Words	What it holds
Primitives	378	35	`dup + @ ! …` as `:inline` words of one instruction each; `exit`, `execute`
Stack and arithmetic	708	32	`rot`, `min`, `umin`, `abs`, `u/mod /mod / mod`, `um* um/mod */`, `within`, the `do` runtime
Variables	406	28	`dp latest dp0 latest0 kcheck starts state base >in #tib`, `tib`, `here allot , c,`, `hex decimal`
Board I/O	302	11	`key? key emit`, `led! led@ btn@ ms@ ms`
Digital pins	248	10	`pin output input high low toggle pin@ pin!`
PWM	334	8	`pwm-hz pwm-khz pwm-duty pwm-pin pwm-off`, `ud/u`
DDS	238	8	`dds-hz dds-khz dds-tuning dds-pin dds-off`, `(dds-hz)`
Analog inputs	186	7	`adc-ch@ adc@ mv@ temp-code@ temp@ .temp`, the table `ain`
Accelerometer	196	8	`acc@ acc! accel? accel-on accel@`

Section of `kernel.fs`	Bytes	Words	What it holds
Serial flash	348	15	`spi f-read f-prog f-erase f-erase64 flash-id crc-reset crc+ crc@`
Saved source	1,572	37	`store autostart erase-source .source source? load-source`, `autoload`, `fkey lfill`
Service requests	2,720	47	`service? serve dispatch answer`, the payload words `p-…`, `rq-store rq-restart`
Output	440	17	`cr space type (.") . u. .s ?`, `unused unused-data buffer:`
Parsing	208	4	`parse-name parse`
Dictionary search	266	6	`find-name name>xt same?`
Numbers	206	3	`digit? >number number?`
Compiler	730	36	`header : ; literal create variable constant if then do loop ( \ ."`
Interpreter	756	11	`words abort ?stack interpret-word interpret accept-line snap quit cold`

Together with the 2-byte reset vector that is the 10,244 bytes. A quarter of the kernel is the service protocol, which on the Zynq is the ARM's job; with the saved source it is 42 %.

5.5 Primitives, inlining and execute

The bottom layer turns machine instructions into words:

```
:inline dup dup ;          :inline + + ;          :inline @ @ ;
:inline i r@ ;
:inline unloop r> drop r> drop ;
```

A `:inline` word's body is copied into a new definition instead of being called: `inline,` copies cells up to the first `exit`. That is why `: sq dup * ;` becomes three instructions (`dup`, `*`, `exit`), and it is essential for the words that touch the return stack: `>r` inside a called word would push onto the wrong frame. `exit` itself cannot be inline (the copy would stop at once); it is an immediate word that compiles the return instruction. In interpret state an inline word is simply executed: its code is the instruction followed by a return.

HF16 has no instruction to call an address held in a register, so `execute` pushes the execution token on the return stack and returns into it:

```
: execute ( xt -- ) >r ;      \ ; compiles exit, which "returns" into xt
```

5.6 The interpreter

```
: quit ( -- )
  0 state !
  begin snap accept-line interpret echo? if state @ 0= if ."  ok" then cr then again ;
```

- **`accept-line`** reads characters with `key` into `tib` until CR or LF, echoes them, handles backspace and DEL, keeps at most 80 and prints a space at the end. While a saved source is being read (`echo?` false) it echoes nothing, and `quit` prints no `ok`.
- **`interpret`** loops `parse-name` → `interpret-word` → `?stack` until the line is used up.
- **`interpret-word`** decides what a name is:

```
: interpret-word ( a n -- )
  2dup find-name ?dup if
    nip nip dup name>xt swap 2 + c@      ( xt count )
    state @ if
      dup $80 and if drop execute
      else $20 and if inline, else compile, then then
    else drop execute then
  else
    2dup number? if
      nip nip state @ if literal then
    else
      drop type ."  ?" cr abort
    then
  then ;
```

- **Numbers** (`number?`): an optional `-`, an optional `$` for hex, digits in `base`. Overflow is not detected; values wrap at 16 bits.
- **`?stack`** guards the 32-entry hardware stack, which wraps silently. A dictionary search needs up to 9 data cells of its own (`find-name` → `match?` → `same?` → `upper`), so more than 20 user items count as overflow, and a depth above 28 means the pointer wrapped below zero (underflow). Both print a message and `abort`.
- **`abort`** stops a running saved source (printing `(in the saved source)`), empties the data stack and calls `quit`. The return stack needs no clearing: `quit` never returns, and a stale return stack only wraps.
- **`snap`** copies the data stack into `ssnap` for the app (section 5.13): it sets `sdepth` to −1, pops the stack into the buffer, pushes it back bottom first, and writes the depth. The `stack` request refuses with `busy` while `sdepth` is negative.
- **`cold`** restores `dp` and `latest` from `dp0` and `latest0` (so the dictionary is the kernel's again), clears the load and answer state (`fsrc fcr serving counting`), counts the start (`starts`), resets the data RAM pointer `dp2` to `$4000`, switches the accelerometer on, sets decimal and interpret state, prints `HF16 Forth on MAX1000`, lights LED1, runs `autoload` and enters `quit`. Typed, `cold` (or `0 execute`) does the same without the hardware reset, so pins, LEDs, PWM and DDS keep their state.

5.7 The compiler

The compiler words are short because the instruction encoding is simple:

```
: compile-call ( xt -- ) 2/ $4000 or , ;
: inline, ( xt -- ) begin dup @ dup [op] exit <> while , 2 + repeat 2drop ;
: literal ( n -- )
  dup 0< if invert $8000 or , [op] invert , else $8000 or , then ; immediate
: header ( a n -- )
  align here >r
  latest @ ,
  dup c,
  here swap dup allot cmove
  align
  r> latest ! ;
: : parse-name header hide ] ;
: ; [op] exit , reveal 0 state ! ; immediate
: create parse-name header here 4 + literal [op] exit , ;
: constant ( n -- ) parse-name header literal [op] exit , ;
```

- `:` builds the header, marks it **hidden** (so the word cannot find itself, and an aborted definition stays invisible, although its space is not reclaimed) and enters compile state; `;` compiles `exit`, reveals the word and leaves compile state. `recurse` compiles a call to the newest word.
- A literal holds 15 bits; a negative one (or one of 32,768 and above, which is the same thing in 16 bits) costs two instructions, the inverted value and `invert`.
- **Control structures** compile branch instructions with an empty target and resolve them later. A placeholder already carries its opcode (`$2000` for 0branch, `$0000` for jump), so resolving is an OR of the target's word address:

```
: >resolve ( orig -- ) dup @ here 2/ or swap ! ;
: if here $2000 , ; immediate          : then >resolve ; immediate
: else here 0 , swap >resolve ; immediate
: begin here ; immediate               : until 2/ $2000 or , ; immediate
: again 2/ , ; immediate               : while here $2000 , swap ; immediate
: repeat 2/ , >resolve ; immediate
```

- **`do … loop`** keeps the limit and the index on the return stack, index on top. `do` inlines `swap >r >r`; `loop` compiles a call to `(loop)` (which increments the index and returns a done flag), a 0branch back to the start of the body and an inlined `unloop`. `i` is therefore `r@`, one instruction; `j` reaches past the inner loop's frame. `+loop` ends when the index reaches or passes the limit, counting upward only.
- `."` compiles a call to `(.")` followed by the counted string, aligned; `(.")` prints it and returns past it by adjusting its own return address.

There is no check that a compile-only word is used inside a definition, and no check for a full code space.

5.8 What lands in RAM

Definitions typed on the simulated HF16 (`tools/hf16.py run`), and the RAM after them (the first new header follows `cold`'s, whose header is at `$278A`):

```
: sq dup * ;
2804  278A  header: link = 278A (cold's header)
2806        count 02, "sq", padding
280A  6001  dup                     inlined primitive
280C  6A83  *                       inlined, one clock
280E  700C  exit

: big? 1000 > if 40000 else -1 then ;
2818  83E8  literal 1000
281A  40EF  call 01DE >
281C  3412  0branch 2824            resolved by else
281E  E3BF  literal 25535           40000 = not 25535
2820  6300  invert
2822  1414  jump 2828               resolved by then
2824  8000  literal 0               -1 = not 0
2826  6300  invert
2828  700C  exit

: count5 5 0 do i . loop ;
2834  8005  literal 5
2836  8000  literal 0
2838  60C0  swap   ┐
283A  6087  >r     │ do
283C  6087  >r     ┘
283E  6601  i = r@
2840  4F51  call 1EA2 .
2842  41F6  call 03EC (loop)
2844  341F  0branch 283E
2846  660D  r>     ┐
2848  6083  drop   │ unloop
284A  660D  r>     │
284C  6083  drop   ┘
284E  700C  exit

variable v
2854  A858  literal 2858            the variable's address
2856  700C  exit
2858  0000                          the value
```

The cross-compiled kernel shows the two optimizations of section 5.1:

```
: led! ( n -- ) $8004 ! ;
06B6  FFFB  literal 32763           $8004 = not 32763
06B8  6300  invert
06BA  60A3  store N at [T]          !
06BC  708F  drop + return           the drop of ! with the exit folded in

: rx? ( -- f ) $8002 @ 1 and 0<> ;
05DC  FFFD  literal 32765
05DE  6300  invert
05E0  6680  @                       reads the I/O register the invert addressed
05E2  8001  literal 1
05E4  6183  and
05E6  00F9  jump 01F2 0<>           tail call
```

A compiled Forth word is real machine code for HF16. One pass of `count5`'s loop is four instructions (`i`, two calls, the 0branch) plus the work of `.` and `(loop)`.

5.9 Integer arithmetic

The hardware multiplies in one clock but does not divide; division is Forth. Figures are instruction counts measured in the simulator, so they are clocks on the board (one clock is 20.8 ns):

- `u/mod` (u d -- rem quot): shift and subtract, 16 iterations of a `do` loop, about 700 instructions (15 µs).
- `/mod`, `/`, `mod` divide the absolute values with `u/mod` and fix the signs afterwards: symmetric division, the quotient rounds toward zero (`-7 2 /` is −3, `-7 2 mod` is −1).
- `um*` (16 × 16 → 32 bits) is `2dup * -rot (um*)`: the low and the high cell of the unsigned product, about 13 instructions with the call.
- `um/mod` (ud u -- rem quot): 32 / 16 long division, 16 iterations, the quotient must fit in 16 bits. The bit shifted out of the high cell is kept on the return stack, so divisors up to 65,535 work. About 790 instructions (16 µs).
- `*/` (n1 n2 n3 -- n4) uses `um*` and `um/mod` on the absolute values with the sign of the result kept on the return stack, so n1 × n2 never overflows in between; about 850 instructions.
- `ud/u` (ud u -- ud'), two `um/mod`s, divides a 32-bit number by a 16-bit one with a 32-bit quotient; `pwm-hz` uses it for 48,000,000 / hz.
- A double cell is (low high), high on top, as in Forth-2012.

```
: um/mod ( ud u -- rem quot )
  -rot
  16 0 do
    dup 0< >r 2* over 0< if 1+ then swap 2* swap
    rot 2dup u< 0= r> or if tuck - rot 1+ swap else -rot then
  loop
  rot drop swap ;
```

5.10 The DDS tuning word

`dds-hz ( hz -- )` must compute tuning = round(hz × 2^{32} / 192,000,000) without a 64-bit type. Since 192,000,000 = 46,875 × 2^{12} and 2^{32} = 2^{20} × 2^{12}, this is round(hz × 2^{20} / 46,875). `(dds-hz)` takes hz as a double (`dds-khz` multiplies kilohertz by 1000 with `um*`), forms hz × 2^{20} as four 16-bit digits (two shifts by 4 and 12 bits, the lowest digit 0), adds half the divisor (23,437) to the lowest digit, and divides by 46,875 one digit at a time with `um/mod`, the remainder of each step becoming the high cell of the next:

```
46875 constant dds-d                  \ tuning = hz * 2^20 / 46875 at 192 MHz
: (dds-hz) ( ud -- )
  over 12 rshift over 4 lshift or >r 12 rshift >r 4 lshift
  r> 0 dds-d um/mod drop
  r> swap dds-d um/mod drop
  dds-d um/mod
  swap 23437 swap dds-d um/mod nip swap dds-tuning ;
```

The quotient digits of the two upper steps would be bits 32 and up of the result; they are zero for any frequency below 192 MHz and dropped. The last two digits are the 32-bit tuning word, which `dds-tuning` writes low half first and then waits for the handshake (`dds-sync`). Adding 23,437 instead of 23,437.5 gives the same rounding for every integer input. The result matches Python's `round(hz * 2**32 / 192e6)` from 1 Hz to 65,535 kHz (`test_protocol.py` checks 1 Hz, 1 MHz and 65,535 kHz; 1,000 Hz gives 22,370). It costs four `um/mod`s, about 3,160 instructions (66 µs).

5.11 Board words

Every board word is a few accesses to the I/O registers:

```
: led! ( n -- ) $8004 ! ;
: ms ( n -- ) ms@ + begin service? dup ms@ - 0< until drop ;
: pin ( n -- mask a )
  dup 0 15 within over 16 24 within or 0= if ."  bad pin" cr abort then
  dup 15 and 1 swap lshift swap 4 rshift 3 lshift $8010 + ;
: output ( n -- ) pin 4 + bset ;
: high ( n -- ) pin 2 + bset ;
: pin@ ( n -- f ) pin @ and 0<> ;
```

`pin` checks the number and turns it into a bit mask and the port's level-register address; `output`, `input`, `high`, `low`, `toggle` read-modify-write the direction or latch register next to it. Further words:

- **PWM:** `pwm ( ch -- a )` checks the channel and gives its register address; `pwm-hz ( hz ch -- )` writes the period 48,000,000 / hz (`ud/u`), `pwm-khz` 48,000 / khz (1..24,000 kHz), `pwm-duty ( permille ch -- )` the duty permille × 65,535 / 1000, `pwm-pin ( pin ch -- )` checks the pin and writes it with bit 15 (on), `pwm-off` clears the control register.
- **DDS:** `dds-hz`, `dds-khz` (section 5.10), `dds-pin ( pin -- )` (checks the pin, writes control with bit 15, waits for the handshake), `dds-off`.
- **Analog:** `adc-ch@ ( c -- u )` reads `$8040 + 2c`; `adc@ ( n -- u )` maps the header input through `ain` (section 4.10); `mv@` is `adc@ 3300 4096 */`; `temp@` is `3798 temp-code@ - 1360 288 */ 400 -` in tenths of a degree; `.temp` prints it.
- **Accelerometer:** `acc@ ( reg -- c )` and `acc! ( c reg -- )` select the LIS3DH (`2 $8022 !`), exchange two bytes and deselect; `accel@ ( -- x y z )` reads the six output bytes in one burst and converts them with `mg` (`8 lshift or` and four `2/`, an arithmetic shift of the left-justified value).
- **Serial flash:** `spi ( c -- c' )` stores the byte, waits while busy and reads the answer; `f-cmd` selects the flash and sends a command, `f-end` deselects, `f-adr ( lo hi -- )` sends a 24-bit address given as a double, `f-wait` polls status bit 0, and on top `f-read` (then `0 spi` per byte), `f-prog ( a n lo hi -- )` (within one page), `f-erase`, `f-erase64`, `flash-id`, `crc-reset crc+ crc@`.

5.12 Saved source and autostart

One Forth source lives in the serial flash, in ZYNQ-FORTH's format:

Flash address	Content
`$000000` (4 KB sector)	header, 16 bytes, little-endian: magic `HF16`, length (32 bits, at most 65,535), CRC-32 of the text (32 bits), flags (bit 0 = autostart)
`$010000` (64 KB block)	the text, lines ending in CR

Everything else in the 8 MB is free for programs (`f-read`, `f-prog`, `f-erase`).

Storing. `store ( len flags -- )` erases the header sector first (so an interrupted store leaves no valid source), prints `ready`, and calls `receive`, which reads `len` raw bytes from the UART (`rx-t`: each within 2 s, else the store ends with `store timeout`). The bytes go into `pbuf` and through the CRC unit; at every 4 KB boundary the next sector is erased, and each 256-byte page is programmed as soon as it is complete. At the end `make-hdr` and `write-hdr` write the header, and `source?` re-reads the whole text and checks it against the CRC before `stored`

`n bytes` is printed. The 8 KB RX FIFO absorbs the flash times: 4 KB arrive in 355 ms at 115,200 Bd, a sector erase takes about 45 ms and 16 page programs about 12 ms. On the board a 49 KB source was stored in 4.9 s, which is the UART's time. `mforth.py --store` and the app's `store` request (section 5.13) use the same `receive`.

Lengths are unsigned: `receive` takes the page length with `umin`, not `min`. During development a signed `min` turned the remaining length of a source over 32 KB negative, and the copy ran over the whole RAM, kernel included.

Boot. `autoload`, called by `cold`:

```
: autoload ( -- )
  0 last-start ! scan-source
  s-state @ 1 = s-auto @ and 0= if exit then
  skip1 @ 0 skip1 ! esc? or btn@ or if     \ btn@ after the wait: the button is
    ."  autostart skipped" cr 2 last-start ! exit   \ sampled every 10 ms
  then
  1 last-start ! s-len @ (load) ;
```

- `scan-source` reads the header and checks the text's CRC over the whole length; it caches the result (`s-state` 0 none, 1 stored, 2 damaged; `s-len`, `s-auto`, `s-crclo/hi`) for the `status` request. A damaged source does not run. Checking 64 KB takes roughly 0.1 s.
- `esc?` waits up to 200 ms for an ESC. It peeks at `$800C`, so other bytes stay in the FIFO, and calls `key?`, so requests are answered meanwhile. `skip1` is set by `restart skip`.
- `btn@` is read **after** the 200 ms wait: right after a reconfiguration the button sampler has not taken its first 10 ms sample, and an earlier read always said "not pressed".
- `(load)` sets `fsrc` to the length. From then on `key` takes its bytes from the source:

```
: lfill ( -- )
  fsrc @ 256 umin lend ! 0 lpos !
  loff @ 1 f-read lend @ 0 do 0 spi lbuf i + c! loop f-end
  lend @ loff +! ;
: fkey ( -- c )
  lpos @ lend @ = if lfill then
  lbuf lpos @ + c@ 1 lpos +! -1 fsrc +!
  fsrc @ 0= if dup 13 <> fcr ! then ;
: key ( -- c )
  fcr @ if 0 fcr ! 13 exit then
  fsrc @ if fkey exit then
  begin key? until $8000 @ ;
```

The text is copied into `lbuf` 256 bytes at a time, and the flash is selected only while a piece is copied. A source may therefore use the flash and the accelerometer on any line. (An earlier version kept the flash selected for the whole load; a line that used `accel@` or the flash words broke the read.) If the last byte is not a CR, `fcr` makes `key` supply one. While `fsrc` or `fcr` is non-zero, `echo?` is false: no echo, no `ok`. The final CR sets `fsrc` to 0 before the last line is interpreted, so the last line's output is followed by `ok`, which serves as the first prompt. An error stops the source through `abort`, which clears `fsrc` and prints `(in the saved source)`; the words defined before the error stay.

5.13 Service requests

The ZYNQ-FORTH app talks **protocol 1** of ZYNQ-FORTH: a request is SOH (0x01), a line, LF; the answer is `SOH ok <name> <length> LF <payload>` or `SOH err <name> <reason> LF`; a 0x01 in Forth's own output is sent twice.

On the Zynq the ARM answers; here the kernel does, on the one CPU, between two bytes of Forth's own input and output.

Where requests are answered. Requests arrive in the RX FIFO between terminal bytes. `service?` answers every request at the head of the FIFO; the words that wait call it:

```
: soh? ( -- f ) rx? if $800C @ 1 = else 0 then ;
: key? ( -- f )
  serving @ if rx? exit then
  begin service? rx? while $800C @ 1 <> if -1 exit then repeat 0 ;
: service? ( -- )
  serving @ if exit then
  $8022 @ 5 and if exit then        \ a word is talking to the flash or the accelerometer
  begin soh? while serve repeat ;
```

`key` (through `key?`), `ms` and the wait in `emit` (while the TX FIFO is full) call `service?`, so answers come at the prompt and whenever a program waits in `ms`, polls `key?`, reads `key` or prints a lot. A word that only computes answers nothing until it ends; Ctrl-R always works because it is hardware. A request queued behind terminal input waits until Forth has read that input, which is why the app sends text in pieces of at most 4 KB (chapter 8).

The head-byte decision. `key?` decides on the byte at the head of the FIFO itself: a SOH there is served, anything else is terminal input. An earlier `key?` called `service?` and then tested "a byte is waiting"; a SOH arriving between the two tests was then read by `key` as a terminal character, and the rest of the request ended up in the input line. The simulator showed that race (section 6.6).

The guards. `serving` keeps an answer from starting another (inside an answer `key?` is the raw test and `service?` returns at once). And nothing is answered while a word has the flash or the accelerometer selected (`$8022` bits 0 or 2): the `board` answer reads the accelerometer and `source` reads the flash, which would break a transfer that word has open. Such requests wait until the word deselects. A consequence to know: a program that calls `key?` while it keeps the flash or the accelerometer selected waits in `key?` for good if a request arrives meanwhile, because the SOH can neither be served nor passed; only Ctrl-R gets out. The kernel's own words never do that.

Serving. `serve` pops the SOH, sets `serving`, and reads the request with `rq-line`: bytes up to LF into `rq` (at most 63 kept), each within 2 s, so an unfinished request is dropped and the terminal goes on. `rq-word` splits off the name, `dispatch` compares it with the known requests (`s" echo" rq=` …) and calls the handler.

Answers in two passes. The length must be in the header, before the payload, and the kernel has no buffer for a payload of several kilobytes. So `answer ( xt -- )` runs the payload word twice: first with `counting` set, where `emit` only counts bytes into `acount`, then for real after the header:

```
: answer ( xt -- )
  base @ >r decimal
  -1 counting ! 0 acount ! dup execute 0 counting !
  1 tx ." ok " rqn-a @ rqn-n @ type space acount @ (u.) lf
  execute r> base ! ;
```

The payload words must produce the same bytes both times. They print hexadecimal values with a fixed width (`hex4`, `hex8`), so live readings such as the ADC codes may change between the passes without changing the length. The decimal numbers of the `status` answer have variable width; of those only `input` can change between the passes (when bytes arrive during the roughly 90 µs of a pass), which would make the announced length wrong by a digit. `source` uses the stored length directly and generates its payload once (`answer-n`). Inside an answer `emit` does not double 0x01, since the reader counts bytes.

Request	Answer payload
`echo <word>`	the word
`version`	`firmware max1000-forth 1.1`, `protocol 1`, `kernel <cells> <kcheck>` (5122 and the image's cell sum in hex, set by the cross-compiler)
`status`	`state running`, `pc 0000` (always: the PC is not readable), `input` = RX FIFO bytes (`$800E`) plus the unread rest of a saved source, `starts`, `source` (`none`, `stored` or `damaged`), `length`, `crc`, `autostart` (`on` or `off`), `last` (`none`, `fed` or `skipped`)
`words`	`here <hex>`, then one line per word, newest first: execution token, flags (`-` or `i` immediate, `h` hidden, `n` inline), name
`stack`	the snapshot of the last prompt: depth, then the cells bottom first in hex; `err stack busy` while `snap` copies
`board`	the board lines below
`source`	the saved text (`err source none` or `damaged`)
`store <len> <crc> on` (or `off`)	erases the header, receives `len` bytes like `store`, checks the CRC; `err store args`, `timeout`, `crc` or `flash`
`erase`	erases the header sector
`autostart on` (or `off`)	rewrites the header's flag; `err autostart none` without a source
`restart [skip]`	answers, waits until the TX FIFO and transmitter are idle (`$8002` bit 2), sets `skip1` for `skip`, and stores to `$8008`
anything else	`err <name> unknown`

The `board` answer, as the app parses it:

```
board 000000A5                bits 7..0 = LED1..LED8, bit 16 = USER button
ports 00280048 00000000       pins 0-15, 16-31: bits 15..0 levels, 31..16 driven
pwm 00000051                  bits 3..0 enabled, then 6 bits per channel's pin
adc 0000 0800 ... 0FFF        the 12-bit codes of ADC channels 0..8
temp 0E38                     the temperature diode's code
accel 0000 0000 03E8          x y z in mg, 16-bit two's complement
dds 8009 01555555             control register, tuning word
```

"Driven" in `ports` is the direction register ORed with the pins owned by an enabled PWM channel (`pwm-own`) or by the DDS (`dds-own`), so the app shows a generator's pin as an output. The app usually restarts with Ctrl-R (and ESC) rather than with the `restart` request, because Ctrl-R also works during a tight loop. There is no HASE mode on the MAX1000.

5.14 What is left out

To keep the kernel within 10 KB of the 16 KB code space, some standard Forth is not there: most double-cell words (`d+`, `m*`, `*/mod`, pictured output `<# # #>`), `char`, `[char]` and `s"` at run time, `accept`, `evaluate`, `?do`, `leave`, `case`, `does>`, `postpone`, `defer`, `marker`, `forget`, `pick`, `roll`, `2swap`, `2over`, `fill`, `move`, `see`, `dump`. Chapter 7 of the manual lists the differences. Each would be some tens to a few hundred bytes of Forth, in the kernel or in the saved source.

6 Tools and verification

6.1 `tools/hf16.py`

One Python file (847 lines) with two parts.

The cross-compiler (`Compiler`, section 5.1). `python tools/hf16.py build forth/kernel.fs -o build/forth` writes:

File	Content
`build/forth_lo.hex`, `forth_hi.hex`	the low and high bytes of all 12,288 cells, for `$readmemh` into the two RAM halves
`build/forth.hex`	the same as whole cells
`build/forth_image.h`	the image and the addresses of `latest`, `dp`, `sdepth`, `ssnap` (kept from ZYNQ-FORTH, where the ARM needs them)
`build/forth.map`	every word's execution token

The instruction-set simulator (`Machine`) executes HF16 instructions as the RTL does: the same encodings, the same 32-entry stacks with wrap-around, the same store semantics and the RX pop only for op 13/14 with T = `$8000`. `python tools/hf16.py run forth/kernel.fs -i "2 3 + ."` (or `-f file`, one line per line, CR appended) runs a session in a fraction of a second, which is how the kernel is developed. It models:

Part	Model
UART	the input bytes; the TX FIFO always has room and the transmitter is always idle
LEDs, button	the register; `--button` holds the USER button
Timer	1 ms per 100 instructions (so `ms` runs about 480 times faster than on the board)
Pins	latch and direction; inputs read low except D6 (the bench button's pull-up)
PWM, DDS	the registers and the pin ownership; a PWM pin reads high only at full duty, the DDS output is not modelled
ADC	AIN3 (CH1) = 2048 (1.65 V), AIN0 (CH8) = 4095 (3.3 V), the rest 0; temperature code 3640 (34.6 °C)
LIS3DH	WHO_AM_I `$33`, x = 0, y = 0, z = 1000 mg; other registers keep what is written
W25Q64	JEDEC ID, status, write enable, read, page program (within the page), 4 KB and 64 KB erase; `--flash image` keeps the first 128 KB in a file between runs
CRC	zlib's `crc32`, as the hardware
SPI	an exchange completes at once (never busy)
Restart	a store to `$8008` resets CPU, LEDs, pins, PWM, DDS and SPI selects; the RAM stays

It does not model the store hazard's undefined read (the compilers never use it), the Ctrl-R byte, the clearing of the RX FIFO by a restart, or any timing below an instruction. A run ends when all input is consumed and Forth has polled the empty FIFO 2,000 times, or after `--steps` instructions.

6.2 `tools/mforth.py`

A line sender for the board (pyserial): each line goes out with a CR, and the tool waits for the answer (ending in CR LF, or a second of silence) before it sends the next, so long files never overrun the FIFO. Lines are limited to 80 characters, as Forth's input line. `--store file` sends `<len> <flags> store`, waits for `ready`, sends the text with CR line ends (at most 65,535 bytes) and waits for `stored`. `--restart` sends Ctrl-R first, `--skip` Ctrl-R and ESC.

6.3 `sim/run_flash_tests.ps1`

23 checks of the flash words and the saved source in the simulator, through a flash image file kept between runs: the JEDEC ID; `store`; autostart runs the source without echo and its variables exist; `.source` lists it; autostart off; `load-source` by hand; the button and an ESC skip it; `cold` restores the dictionary; an error stops the source (words before it exist, words after it not); a source without a final CR; flash and accelerometer words inside a saved source, and the terminal after it; a 41 KB source (more than 32 KB, many pages) stored and run; `erase-source`.

6.4 `sim/test_protocol.py`

41 checks of the service requests, driving the simulator byte by byte and splitting its output into terminal text and answers as the app does: the banner; `echo`; `version` (with the checksum recomputed from the image); `status`; `stack` and the empty stack; `words` (all 323 words, flags, a new word first); `board` at the start, with pins, PWM and LEDs, with the temperature and the accelerometer, with the DDS on pin 9 at 1 MHz; DDS tuning words at 1 Hz and 65,535 kHz against Python; the data RAM and its end, `buffer:` and its alignment; no answer while the flash is selected; `store` (also with a wrong CRC), `source`, `restart` and `restart skip` with their effect on `status`; `autostart` on, off and with bad arguments; `erase`; an unknown request; an answer during `ms` that comes before the line's `ok`; a SOH printed by Forth arriving doubled; an unfinished request dropped after 2 s; a 15 KB store.

`scripts/Build-Release.ps1` runs both test scripts before every release build.

6.5 Checks on the board

- **Boot:** after `program_flash.ps1`, RESET (a reconfiguration from the internal flash) starts MAX1000-FORTH with the kernel image from the `.pof`.
- **Flash:** `flash-id` reads EF 40 17; the board's W25Q64 was blank on delivery; the CRC unit gives 0x66D2DB21 for `examples/bench.fs`, as zlib; a 49 KB source is stored in 4.9 s.
- **Accelerometer:** WHO_AM_I reads `$33`; the board lying flat gives z ≈ +1024 mg.
- **Temperature:** about 31.7 °C on the bench.
- **ADC:** a potentiometer on AIN3 confirmed the channel table and the settling fix.
- **DDS:** a Forth loop counted the edges on the DDS pin with `pin@` for one second: 100 Hz gave 200 edges, 1 kHz 2001, 10 kHz 20,010 and 20,015.
- **App protocol:** with ZYNQ-FORTH's `tools/zforth.py` and with the app itself, including the live board view while a program runs.

6.6 Found on the way

The simulator and the board found these, and each is now covered by a check or a rule:

Finding	Cause	Fix
a request byte appeared in the input line	`key?` tested for a SOH and then for "a byte waiting"; a SOH in between was read as terminal input	`key?` decides on the head byte (peek `$800C`)
a source over 32 KB overwrote the whole RAM	a signed `min` made the remaining length negative	`umin`; lengths are unsigned throughout
the button never skipped the autostart	it was read before its first 10 ms sample	read after the 200 ms ESC wait
a saved source could not use the flash or the accelerometer	the flash stayed selected during the whole load	the source is copied into `lbuf` 256 bytes at a time; no answers while a device is selected
a `buffer:` of odd size misaligned the next one	sizes were taken as given	`buffer:` rounds the size up to even
inputs read the wrong channel, open inputs copied others	one conversion did not settle after another channel; the header labels are not in channel order	four conversions per channel, the last kept; the `ain` table
48 MHz missed timing by 0.66 ns	the I/O read multiplexer was behind the next-T path	the multiplexer works from the registered `io_addr`
the ADC core did not take the channel mask	`analog_input_pin_mask` was given as a sized vector	an integer, 65,791

7 Building, flashing and releasing

7.1 The build chain

```
forth/kernel.fs  --tools/hf16.py build----->  build/forth_lo.hex, forth_hi.hex, forth.map
rtl/*.v, constr/max1000_forth.sdc,
Intel's ADC control core,
forth_lo/hi.hex  --scripts/build.tcl (Quartus)-->  build/output_files/max1000_forth.sof, .pof
.pof or .sof     --scripts/program_flash.ps1--->  the MAX1000 (JTAG, Arrow USB Blaster)
```

`scripts/build.ps1` runs the first two steps: it builds the kernel image, then `quartus_sh -t scripts/build.tcl` with the output in `build/quartus.log`, prints errors, critical warnings (except 16248 and 16562, which are expected) and the slack and resource lines of the reports. It finds Quartus through `-Quartus`, `QUARTUS_ROOTDIR` or `<drive>:\Quartus\18.1\quartus`. It needs **Quartus Prime Lite 18.1** with MAX 10 support and Python 3. Because the kernel is part of the configuration, every kernel change needs a new Quartus build; the simulator is the fast path for kernel work.

7.2 `scripts/build.tcl`

It creates the project in `build/` and compiles it:

- device `10M08SAU169C8G`, family MAX 10, core supply 3.0 V, VCCA 3.3 V, default I/O standard 3.3-V LVTTL (the USER button as 3.3 V Schmitt trigger);
- `INTERNAL_FLASH_UPDATE_MODE "SINGLE IMAGE WITH ERAM"`: the configuration flash holds one image *with* the initial RAM contents, so the `.pof` carries the kernel;
- `RESERVE_ALL_UNUSED_PINS_WEAK_PULLUP` as inputs with weak pull-ups;
- the eight Verilog files of `rtl/`, the six files of the Modular ADC control core from the Quartus installation (`ip/altera/altera_modular_adc/control`), the SDC file;
- the parameters `INIT_LO` and `INIT_HI` set to the two hex files (with absolute paths);
- all pin locations (section 2.1, 4.7);
- with the environment variable `MAX1000_PULLUPS=1` (set by `build.ps1 -PullUps`), weak pull-ups on `D[*]` and `PIO[*]`.

7.3 The kernel in the configuration

The RAM halves are declared with `initial $readmemh(INIT_LO, ram_lo)` and `$readmemh(INIT_HI, ram_hi)`. Quartus turns the files into the M9K blocks' initial contents (the fitter report lists them), and with "single image with ERAM" the assembler puts those contents into the `.pof` next to the logic. At every power-up or RESET the MAX 10 copies both into the chip, and the CPU, released from reset, finds the jump to `cold` at address 0. There is no loader anywhere: the RAM simply starts out holding the kernel.

The same holds for the `.sof` loaded over JTAG for a quick try. Since a Ctrl-R does not touch the RAM, a kernel damaged by a program (a store into the code space) survives Ctrl-R; RESET, which reloads the configuration from the internal flash, restores it.

7.4 Getting it onto the board

`scripts/program_flash.ps1` (in a release: `firmware\program_flash.ps1`) finds `quartus_pgm` (in `-Quartus`, `QUARTUS_ROOTDIR`, the PATH, or the usual install folders of the Quartus Prime Programmer or Quartus on every drive), runs `jtagconfig` and programs over the Arrow USB Blaster (cable 1 by default):

- without options, `max1000_forth.pof` into the internal flash: MAX1000-FORTH starts at every power-up; press RESET or replug USB to start it now;
- with `-Sram`, `max1000_forth.sof` into the FPGA only, until power-off.

It takes the files from its own folder (a release) or from `build\output_files` (the repository). The serial flash with the saved source is not touched by either.

7.5 Releases

`scripts/Build-Release.ps1 -Version 1.1` runs the two simulator test scripts, builds the kernel and the configuration, builds `docs/Manual.pdf` with `tools/manual_pdf.py` (Python `markdown` and Microsoft Edge; `-SkipPdf` uses the committed PDF) and writes `dist/MAX1000-FORTH-<version>.zip` with:

Folder	Content
`firmware/`	`max1000_forth.pof`, `max1000_forth.sof`, `program_flash.ps1`
`docs/`	`Manual.pdf`, `design.md`, `images/`
`tools/`	`mforth.py`, `hf16.py`
`examples/`	`bench.fs`
top	`README.md`, `CHANGELOG.md`, `LICENSE`

Release **1.0** (2026-11-05) was the first: CPU, kernel, terminal, board words, saved source, app support. Release **1.1** (2026-11-06) added the DDS and the `dds` line of the `board` answer. Both are published at github.com/andiepp/MAX1000-FORTH.

8 The Windows app

MAX1000-FORTH has no app of its own: the **ZYNQ-FORTH app** (2.4 and later, C#/WPF, in the ZYNQ-FORTH repository) serves both boards. Everything it shows comes through protocol 1, so any other program can do the same (`tools/zforth.py` of ZYNQ-FORTH is a command-line example).

Part (ZYNQ-FORTH `app/src`)	What it does for the MAX1000
`ZynqForth.Core/Board/BoardModels.cs`	`BoardVersion.Kind`: the `firmware` line of the `version` answer names `max1000-forth`, so the board is a `BoardKind.Max1000` (else `Zynq`); `Product` gives "MAX1000-FORTH" for messages
`ViewModels/MainViewModel.cs`	after connecting, `SetBoardKind`; for a MAX1000 it sets `client.InputWindow` = 4 KB and `client.RestartByCtrlR` = true, hides the Pattern tab (the MAX1000 has no pattern generator) and remembers the kind; the board view polls `board` every 250 ms, the status line `status` every 1.5 s
`ZynqForth.Core/Board/BoardClient.cs`	`SendTextAsync` ("Run all") sends text only while `InputWindow` minus the `input` of `status` leaves at least 1 KB, so a piece is at most 4 KB and the 8 KB RX FIFO never overflows; `RestartAsync` sends Ctrl-R, or Ctrl-R and ESC for "Restart clean", instead of the `restart` request
`ZynqForth.Core/Board/Max1000State.cs`	parses the `board` answer: LEDs, button, both ports (levels and driven), PWM enables and pins, the 9 ADC codes mapped to AIN0..AIN7 and AIN (the same table as the kernel's `ain`), the temperature (the same interpolation as `temp@`) and the accelerometer; the `dds` line is not decoded, but the DDS pin shows as a driven pin
`Controls/Max1000View.cs`	draws the MAX1000: 8 LEDs, the USER button, the chip temperature and the tilt in g, the PWM channels and their pins, the 23 pins (input, output high/low, PWM), bars for the 9 analog inputs in volts
`Views/MainWindow.xaml.cs`	`OpenManual` (Manual button, F1): for a MAX1000 it opens the MAX1000-FORTH manual embedded in the app, written to `%LocalAppData%\ZYNQ-FORTH`

Why the smaller input window: on the Zynq the ARM keeps a 64 KB input ring and answers at once; on the MAX1000 a `status` request queued behind 16 KB of text would be answered only after Forth has compiled all of it. With 4 KB pieces each answer comes quickly and the progress display stays live. Why Ctrl-R: the `restart` request is answered only when Forth waits, Ctrl-R always.

9 Design decisions and room for growth

9.1 Decisions

Decision	Why
HF16 unchanged from ZYNQ-FORTH	one CPU, one instruction set, one cross-compiler and simulator for both boards; the kernel's core carries over
No soft processor; the kernel answers the app	the 10M08 has room for HF16 and the peripherals but not for a second CPU with its memory; the protocol is simple enough for Forth
The kernel as the RAM's initial content	no loader, no boot time, nothing to go wrong between power-up and the banner; the cost is a Quartus build per kernel change
Ctrl-R in hardware	the only way to stop a tight loop when no other processor watches the CPU
I/O read multiplexer on the registered address	takes the I/O decode off the critical path: 48 MHz instead of 40, at the cost of one 16-bit register
Two byte-wide RAM halves	byte stores without relying on inferred byte enables; 24 M9K either way
Stacks in M9K	the MAX 10 has no LUT RAM; two M9K blocks are cheaper than 1,024 flip-flops with multiplexers
16 KB of code, 8 KB of data RAM	the 13-bit addresses of HF16 reach 16 KB; the rest of the RAM is still useful as data (`buffer:`, the kernel's buffers)
8 KB RX FIFO	flash erase times during `store`, and room for the app's 4 KB pieces
Answers generated twice	no payload buffer in a 24 KB machine; fixed-width hex keeps both passes the same length
No answers while a device is selected	the `board` and `source` answers use the SPI bus; interleaving would corrupt a transfer in progress
The saved source in 256-byte pieces	the source may use the flash and the accelerometer itself
Four ADC conversions per channel	high-impedance sources settle; costs only conversion rate, of which there is plenty
DDS on its own 192 MHz clock	5.2 ns edge resolution and 0.045 Hz steps from a single adder; the handshake keeps the CPU side at 48 MHz
Pull-ups off by default, a build option	LEDs on the bench pins; Forth cannot switch the MAX 10's pull-ups

9.2 Room for growth

The 1.1 design leaves, of the 10M08:

- **Logic:** 3,805 logic elements free (47 %). The four PWM channels alone use 1,734; a fifth peripheral of the DDS's size (150 logic elements) fits many times over.
- **Block RAM:** 6 M9K free (6 KB as byte-wide memory). Enough for bigger FIFOs, a small second buffer, a UART or SPI peripheral's FIFOs, or a deeper return stack.
- **Multipliers:** 30 of 48 9-bit elements free.

- **PLL:** 2 of 5 outputs free, for another clock domain.
- **UFM:** the user flash block inside the MAX 10 is unused.
- **Code space:** 6,140 bytes for typed words; the missing Forth words (section 5.14) would fit in the kernel at some tens to hundreds of bytes each.
- **Data RAM:** 7,168 bytes for `buffer:`, plus 224 unused bytes among the kernel's buffers.
- **Pins:** the header's analog pins are taken by the ADC; all 23 digital pins and the Pmod are in use as GPIO, and each can carry a PWM channel or the DDS.

Natural extensions that need no change to what exists: more PWM channels or DDS outputs, a UART or I^2C master routed to any pin (as in ZYNQ-FPGA-FORTH32), a pin ownership table in the kernel, and decoding of the `dds` line in the app.

9.3 What would not fit

- **More than 16 KB of code.** The PC and the branch targets are 13-bit word addresses; more code space means a different instruction format, a different CPU.
- **More RAM.** 24 KB uses 24 of the 42 M9K; 32 KB would need 8 more, and only 6 are free.
- **HF32.** The 32-bit CPU of ZYNQ-FPGA-FORTH32, with its FPU and divider, takes 8,321 of the Zynq's 6-input LUTs, more than the whole 10M08 offers in 4-input logic elements.
- **The pattern generator** of the Zynq designs: its 4,096 × 80-bit pattern memory alone is more than the free block RAM.
- **A second core.** Another HF16 with its own 24 KB would need 24 more M9K.